HOOVER INSTITUTION | Stanford University

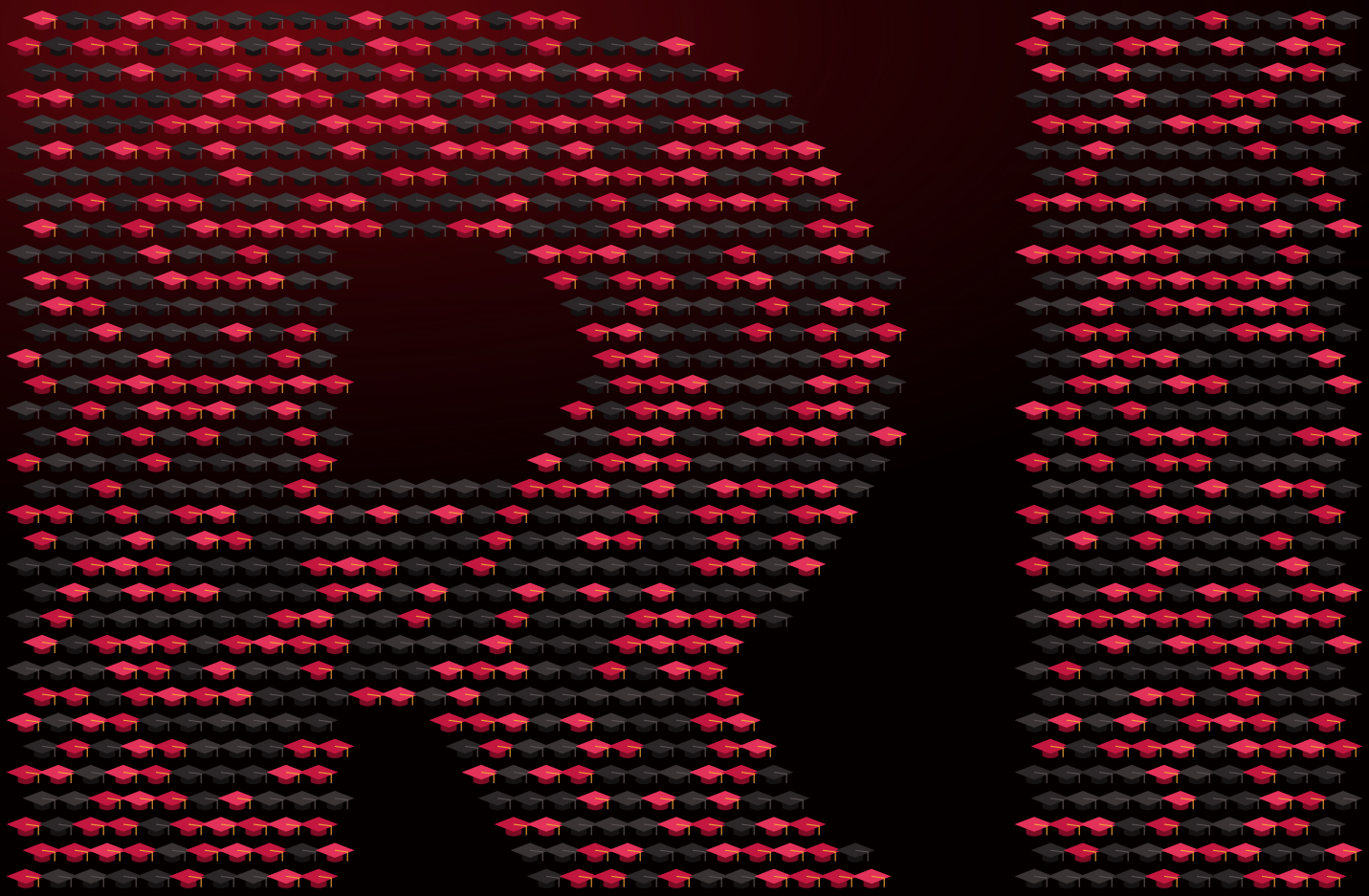
HAI Stanford University Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence

NOVEMBER 2026

The 2026 Rhode Island Talent Profile

Emerson Johnston
Amy Zegart

The bright caps, **47 in every 100**, mark the international share of Rhode Island's STEM master's degrees.



The 2026 Rhode Island Talent Profile

By Emerson Johnston and Amy Zegart

NOVEMBER 2026

A publication jointly produced by the Hoover Institution and the Institute for Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence at Stanford University.

Table of Contents

OVERVIEW

At a Glance 6

SECTIONS

Section 1 International Dependence 8
Section 2 STEM Degrees 20
Section 3 Where Students Come From 26
Section 4 K-12 Preparation 34
Section 5 Graduate Research 36
Section 6 Do Graduates Stay? 38
Section 7 Research Funding 40
Section 8 H-1B Jobs and Green Cards 42
Section 9 STEM Workforce 46
Section 10 Patents 48
Section 11 Competitors 50
Section 12 Fields of Study 52
Section 13 Students and Money 62
Section 14 Student Outcomes 70
Section 15 Faculty 74
Section 16 Institutions 78

BACK MATTER

About these Data 82
By the Numbers 84
Sources 93

Authors

Emerson Victoria Johnston is a research assistant with the Hoover Institution's Technology Policy Accelerator. A Knight-Hennessy Scholar, she holds a master's in international policy from Stanford University, and is on leave from its master's program in the history of science, technology, environment, and medicine.

Dr. Amy Zegart is the Morris Arnold and Nona Jean Cox Senior Fellow at the Hoover Institution, director of Hoover's Technology Policy Accelerator, and a senior fellow and associate director at Stanford University's Institute for Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence.

Data come from the Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS), the Department of Homeland Security's SEVIS by the Numbers, the National Assessment of Educational Progress, NSF's Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates and Survey of Earned Doctorates, the Department of Labor's Office of Foreign Labor Certification, the USCIS H-1B Employer Data Hub, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and USPTO patent data via PatentsView, processed in Python; every figure and table is generated from those sources, and each one names its source.

About This Profile

This profile is a companion to *The 2026 US Talent Report: Benchmarking America's STEM Pipeline Amid the Great Talent Competition*. It applies the report's measures to Rhode Island: the students the state develops at home, those it draws from abroad, and how both compare with the nation and with the states closest to it in size.

Degrees, enrollment, prices, outcomes and faculty come from IPEDS, the federal census of U.S. colleges and universities, harmonized across 1980–2025. Countries of citizenship come from SEVIS by the Numbers, the Department of Homeland Security's monthly count of active F-1 and M-1 students. Each figure names its source. Peer states are the four closest in total fall enrollment.

HOOVER INSTITUTION | Stanford University
HAI Stanford University Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence
The 2026 Rhode Island Talent Profile

How to Cite this Profile

Emerson V. Johnston and Amy Zegart, “The 2026 Rhode Island Talent Profile,” Technology Policy Accelerator, Hoover Institution, and the Institute for Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence, Stanford University, Stanford, CA, November 2026.

Public Data and Tools

The data behind every chart come from federal sources: the Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS), published by the National Center for Education Statistics, as the backbone, together with NAEP, NSF's surveys of graduate students, doctorates and research funding, USAspending.gov, DHS and ICE SEVIS data, the Department of Labor, USCIS, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes, and USPTO PatentsView. Each figure names its source, and the Sources page lists all of them. An interactive version of this profile accompanies the report.

To share any charts and figures, proper attribution is required. This profile is licensed under Attribution-NoDerivatives 4.0 International (CC BY-ND 4.0). Please cite as: The 2026 Rhode Island Talent Profile.

AT A GLANCE

What Rhode Island's numbers say

1. **International students earn 47% of Rhode Island's STEM master's degrees,** 4.7 points below the U.S. (52%) in 2025, ranking 24th of 51 on dependence. The share is 38% for STEM research doctorates (U.S. 43%) and 6.6% for STEM bachelor's (U.S. 6.6%).
2. **Rhode Island awarded 406 STEM master's degrees to international students in 2025,** 0.3% of the U.S. total and 36th of 51 among states. Since 2015 the count changed 2.3×, against 2.2× nationally.
3. **The heaviest dependence is in engineering,** where international students earned 62% of master's degrees (235 degrees; U.S. 49%). 2 STEM fields with at least 50 master's graduates are majority-international.
4. **Among states of similar size,** Rhode Island ranks 2nd of 5 on the international share of STEM master's: Rhode Island 47%, Maine 8.8%, Hawaii 16%, Delaware 72%, District of Columbia 33%.
5. **41% of Rhode Island's first-time students in fall 2024 were state residents** and 4.5% came from abroad. More students arrived from other states (7.9K) than residents left (2.84K), a net gain of 5.06K; the top destination for those leaving was Massachusetts.

47%

of the STEM master's degrees Rhode Island awards go to international students (U.S. 52%).

SCORECARD

Nine numbers against the nation

75.6K #43
Students enrolled, 2024
U.S. **19.7M** · −8.1% since 2015

406 #36
International STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **117K** · 2.31× since 2015

47% #24
International share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · +8.9 pp since 2015

18% #15
International share of grad students, 2024
U.S. **17%** · +0.4 pp since 2015

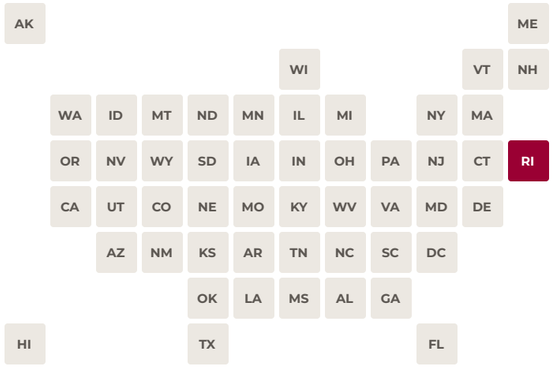
23% #25
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025
U.S. **24%** · +5.7 pp since 2015

74% #3
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · +5.2 pp since 2015

$8.67K #42
Appropriations per student, 2024
U.S. **$11.4K** · +28% since 2015

41% #48
First-time students from in state, 2024
+4.0 pp since 2016

$120K #7
Average faculty salary, 2024
U.S. **$106K** · −5.2% since 2016



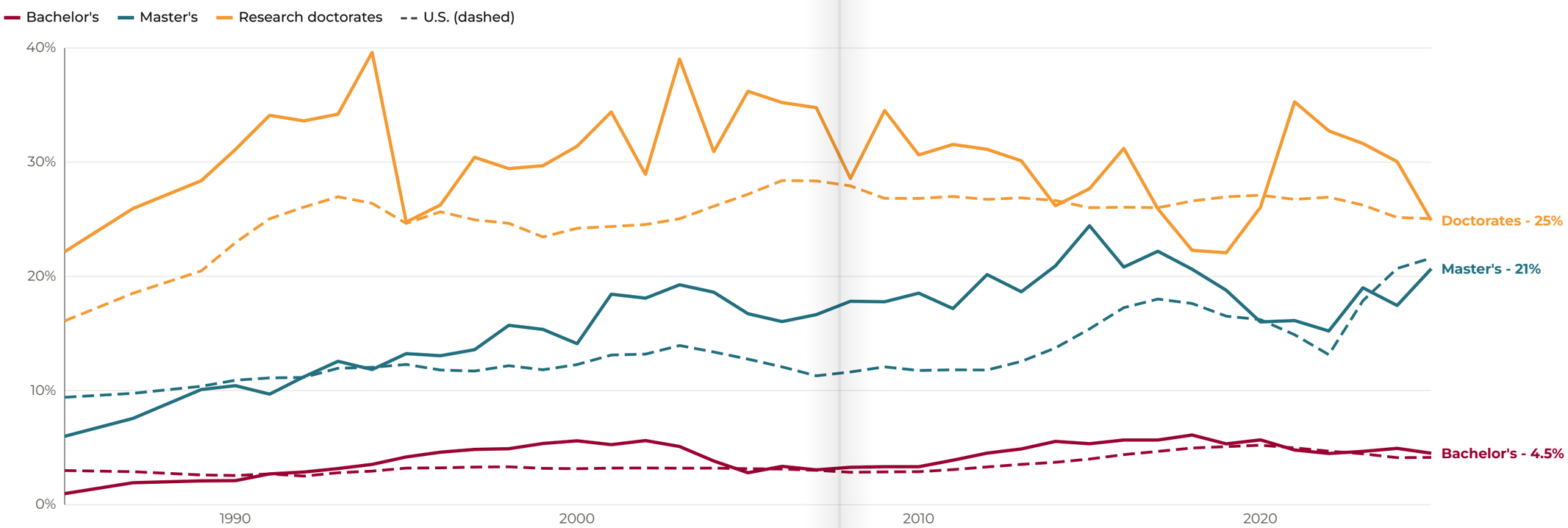
Badges give Rhode Island's rank among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). Changes are since 2015.

SECTION 1

International Dependence

Rhode Island ranks 15th of 51 on the international share of graduate enrollment, at 18% in 2024 against 17% for the U.S.

Figure 1 What Share of Rhode Island's Degrees Go to International Students?



International share of degrees awarded, all fields; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions, 1985–2025.

International students make up 18% of Rhode Island's graduate enrollment and 5.7% of its undergraduates. Dependence climbs with each degree: 4.5% of bachelor's, 21% of master's and 25% of research doctorates go to international students.

In STEM the shares are higher still: 6.6% of STEM bachelor's, 47% of STEM master's and 38% of STEM doctorates. The state awards 0.3% of all U.S. international STEM master's, 36th of 51.

18%

Int. share of grad students, 2024

U.S. **17%** · **15th** of 51 · +0.4 pp since 2015

21%

Int. share of all master's, 2025

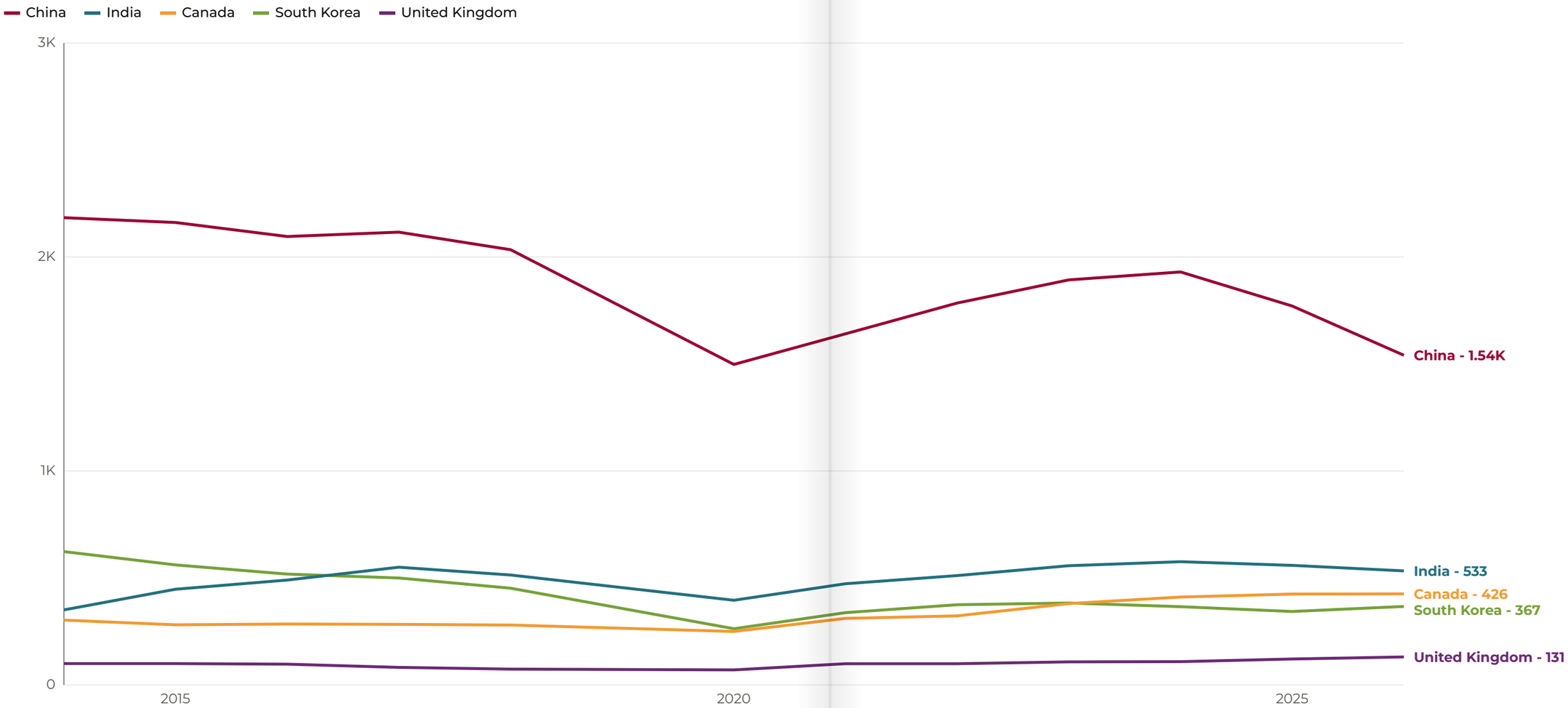
U.S. **22%** · **17th** of 51 · −3.8 pp since 2015

47%

Int. share of STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **52%** · **24th** of 51 · +8.9 pp since 2015

Figure 2 Where Do Rhode Island's International Students Come From?



Active F-1 and M-1 students by country of citizenship, the five largest in October 2026; one fall snapshot per year (the month closest to November), October 2014–October 2026. All education levels. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers.

In October 2026, Rhode Island had 5.06K active international students in SEVIS, 37th of 51. China accounted for 30% of them and India for 11%, against 18% and 27% nationally.

Students came from 139 countries, but the two largest supplied 41%. The state's total is down 17% since 2015, when it stood at 6.09K.

5.06K
Active international students, October 2026
37th of 51 · U.S. **1.19M**

30%
From China
U.S. **18%**

54%
In STEM fields
U.S. **63%**

SECTION 1 · INTERNATIONAL DEPENDENCE

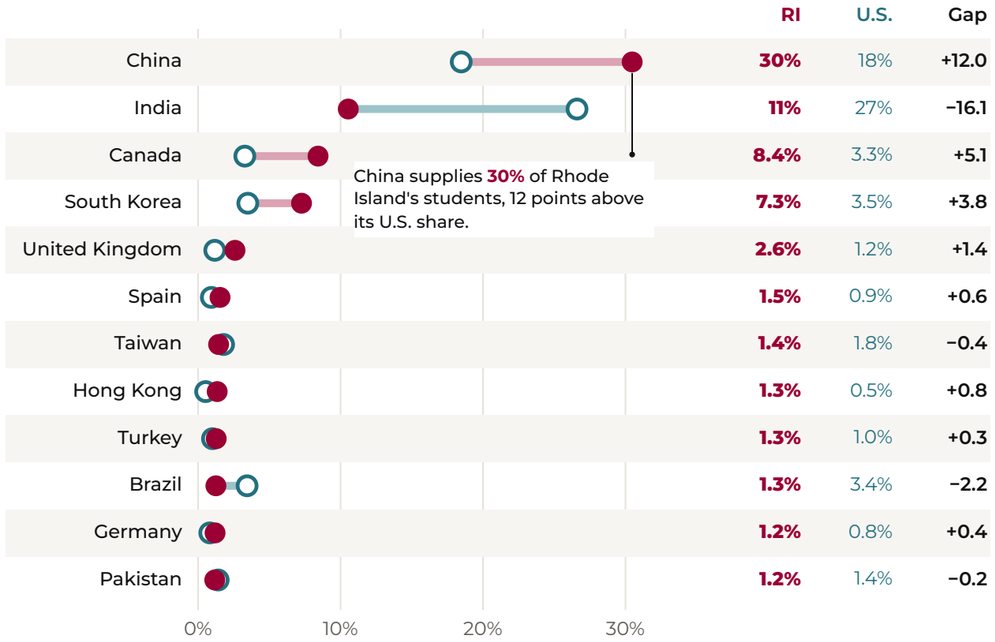
How Does Rhode Island's Mix of Countries Compare With the Nation's?

In October 2026, Rhode Island had **5.06K** active F-1 and M-1 students, 37th among the 50 states and DC and **0.4%** of the U.S. total. They came from 139 countries.

China supplied **30%** of them, against 18% nationally, and India **11%**, against 27%. Canada (8.4%), South Korea (7.3%), and the United Kingdom (2.6%) followed.

Together the two largest countries supplied **41%** of the state's international students (U.S. 45%), 22nd among the states, against 45% in 2015.

Figure 3 Is Rhode Island's Mix of Countries Like the Nation's?



Share of active F-1 and M-1 students, all levels. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers, October 2026.

5.06K
Active international students, October 2026
37th of 51 · U.S. **1.19M**

30%
From China
U.S. **18%**

11%
From India
U.S. **27%**

139
Countries represented
U.S. **219**

The state's count is down 5.2% from 2025 and down 17% since 2015, when it stood at 6.09K. Its share of all U.S. international students is down 0.1 points since 2015, to **0.4%**.

Since 2015, the number of students from China went from 2.16K to 1.54K, India's from 447 to 533, and Canada's from 281 to 426.

Over the same years, the number from South Korea went from 561 to 367 and the United Kingdom's from 100 to 131. The table gives each country's count for the first, previous and latest years.

Table 1 International Students in Rhode Island, 2015–2026

	2015	2025	2026	Change since 2015	U.S. 2026	Rank
ALL INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS						
Active F-1 and M-1 students	6.09K	5.34K	**5.06K**	−17%	1.19M	37th
Share of U.S. active F-1/M-1 students	0.5%	0.4%	**0.4%**	−0.1 pp	–	37th
Countries of citizenship represented	148	143	**139**	−6.1%	219	41st
Share from the two largest countries of origin	45%	44%	**41%**	−3.7 pp	45%	22nd
LARGEST COUNTRIES OF CITIZENSHIP (STUDENTS)					**U.S. SHARE**	**STATE SHARE**
China	2.16K	1.77K	**1.54K**	−29%	18%	30%
India	447	559	**533**	+19%	27%	11%
Canada	281	425	**426**	+52%	3.3%	8.4%
South Korea	561	343	**367**	−35%	3.5%	7.3%
United Kingdom	100	121	**131**	+31%	1.2%	2.6%

Active F-1 and M-1 students, one fall snapshot per year (the month closest to November; 2019 has none; the latest year is October 2026). Rank among the 50 states and DC. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers.

Figure 4

Which Countries Supply Rhode Island's International STEM Students?

2.73K of Rhode Island's international students were in STEM fields in October 2026, **54%** of the total against 63% nationally, up 78% since 2015.

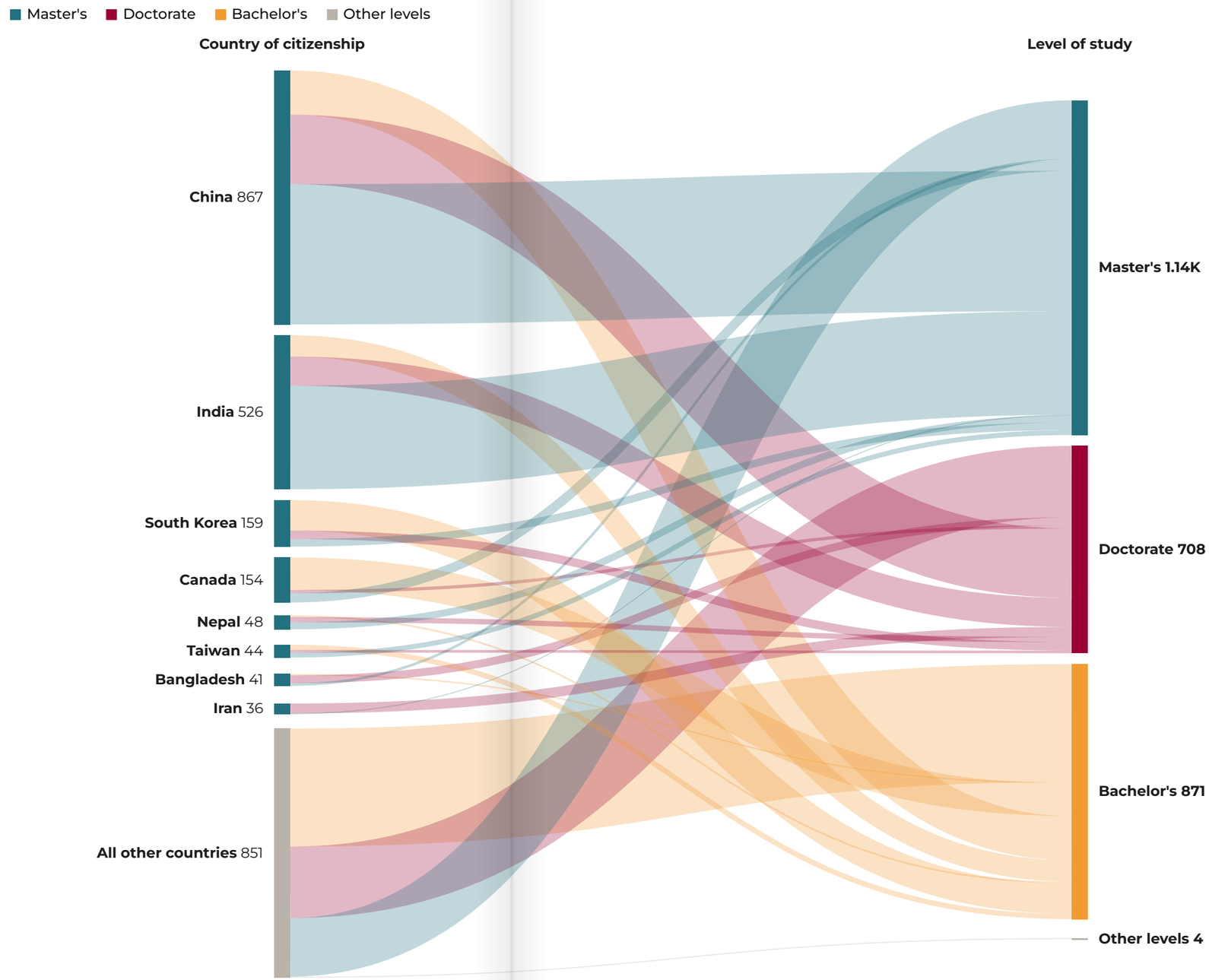
Master's students were the largest group, **1.14K**. China supplied 42% of them and India 31%.

STEM doctoral students went from 526 in 2015 to **708**, and STEM master's students from 361 to 1.14K.

2.73K
Active STEM F-1/M-1 students, 2026
U.S. **749K** · **36th** of 51 · +78% since 2015

54%
Share in STEM fields
U.S. **63%**

1.14K
Active STEM master's students, 2026
U.S. **393K** · **37th** of 51 · 3.17× since 2015



Active F-1 and M-1 students in STEM fields by country of citizenship and level of study, October 2026; the eight largest countries are shown. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers, October 2026.

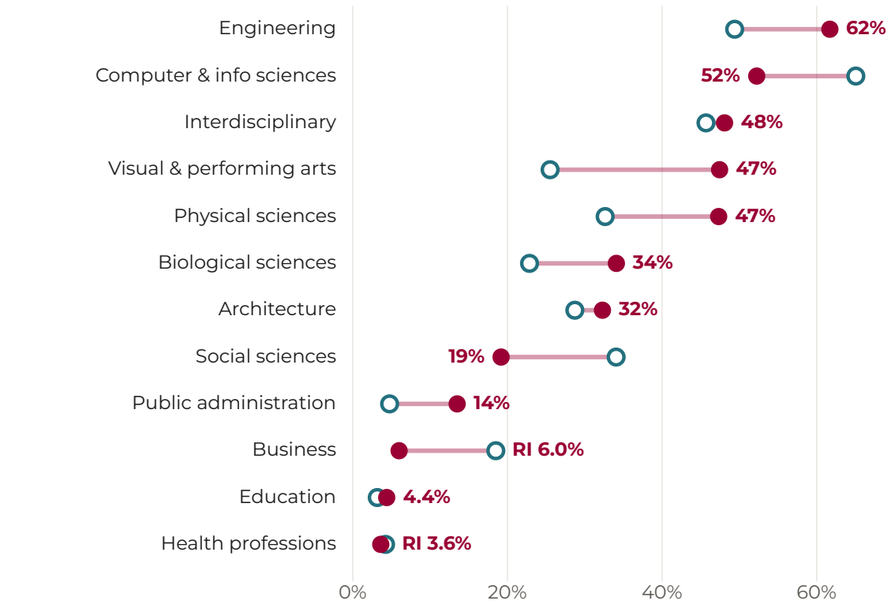
SECTION 1 · INTERNATIONAL DEPENDENCE

How International Are Rhode Island's Master's Fields?

Each row is a master's field with at least 30 graduates in Rhode Island in 2025, ranked by the share of degrees earned by international students (U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas). The filled dot is the state's share; the open dot is the national share for the same field.

Highest international shares. International students earned the largest shares of master's degrees in engineering (62%, against 49% for the U.S.), computer & info sciences (52%, against 65% for the U.S.), and interdisciplinary (48%, against 46% for the U.S.).

Figure 5 Which Master's Fields Depend Most on International Students?



International share of master's degrees by field, 2025; fields with 30+ graduates. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

21%
Int. share of all master's, 2025
U.S. **22%** · **17th** of 51

47%
Int. share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · **24th** of 51

52%
Int. share of CS master's, 2025
U.S. **65%** · **30th** of 47

The table gives the international share of degrees in each STEM field at three levels: Rhode Island first, the United States after the slash. The master's column is highlighted. A dash means the state awarded no degrees in the field at that level.

Highest international share among STEM master's fields. International students earned 62% of the master's degrees in engineering, against 49% for the U.S.

Fields with an international majority. International students earned more than half of the master's degrees in 2 STEM fields.

Table 2 How International Is Each STEM Field?

Field	Bachelor's	Master's	Doctorates
Computer & info sciences	12% / 8.6%	**52% / 65%**	55% / 56%
Engineering	3.4% / 7.2%	**62% / 49%**	45% / 55%
Engineering technology	0.0% / 4.5%	**– / 54%**	– / 42%
Math & statistics	11% / 17%	**29% / 55%**	– / 53%
Physical sciences	6.6% / 6.0%	**47% / 33%**	36% / 38%
Biological sciences	2.2% / 3.4%	**34% / 23%**	19% / 23%
Natural resources	2.3% / 2.0%	**17% / 17%**	– / 27%
Architecture	20% / 7.3%	**32% / 29%**	– / 55%

International share in Rhode Island / U.S., 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

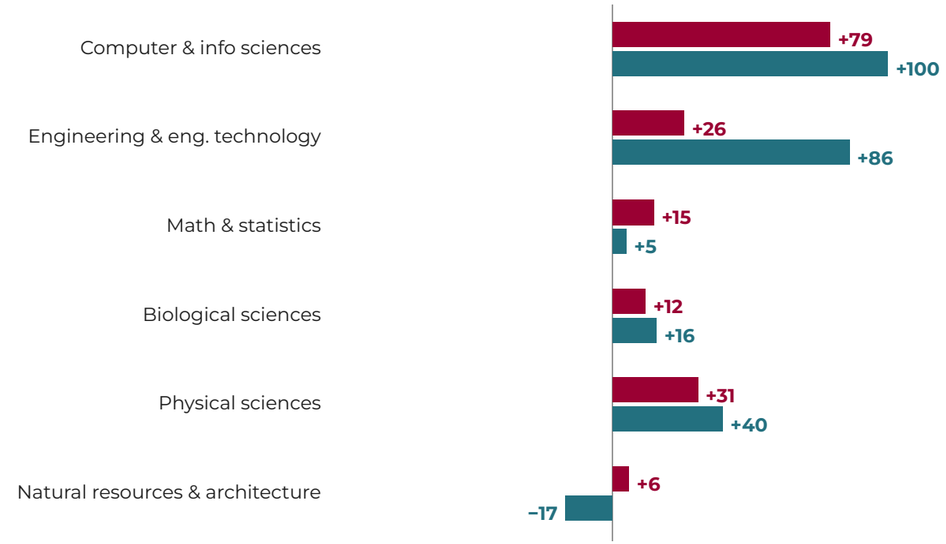
SECTION 1 · INTERNATIONAL DEPENDENCE

How Has Rhode Island's STEM Master's Output Grown?

Each pair of bars is the change in the number of STEM master's degrees awarded in Rhode Island between 2015 and 2025 in one field: to domestic students (U.S. citizens and permanent residents) and to international students. Bars to the left of the axis are declines.

STEM master's degrees. The state awarded 857 in 2025 and 458 in 2015, a change of +230 for international students and +169 for domestic students.

Figure 6 Where Did the STEM Master's Growth Come From?



Change in STEM master's degrees by field, 2015–2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

406
International STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **117K** · **36th** of 51

23%
STEM share of master's, 2025
U.S. **23%** · **19th** of 51

0.3%
Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025
36th of 51

4.5
STEM master's per STEM research doctorate, 2025
U.S. **6.4** · **35th** of 51

The table gives the number of STEM master's degrees awarded in Rhode Island in each field in 2015 and 2025, the change between the two years, the number awarded to international students in 2025, and international students' share of the field's degrees in each year.

STEM share of master's degrees. The share was 23% in 2025, against 23% for the U.S., 19th among the states, up 0.2 points from 23% in 2024 and up 5.6 points since 2015, when it was 18%.

Table 3 How Many STEM Master's Degrees Does Each Field Award?

Field	2015	2025	Change	International 2025	Int. share 2015	Int. share 2025
Computer & info sciences	66	**245**	+271%	128	42%	52%
Engineering & eng. technology	125	**237**	+90%	145	47%	61%
Math & statistics	29	**49**	–	14	–	29%
Biological sciences	60	**88**	+47%	30	23%	34%
Physical sciences	41	**112**	–	53	32%	47%
Natural resources & architecture	137	**126**	−8.0%	36	39%	29%

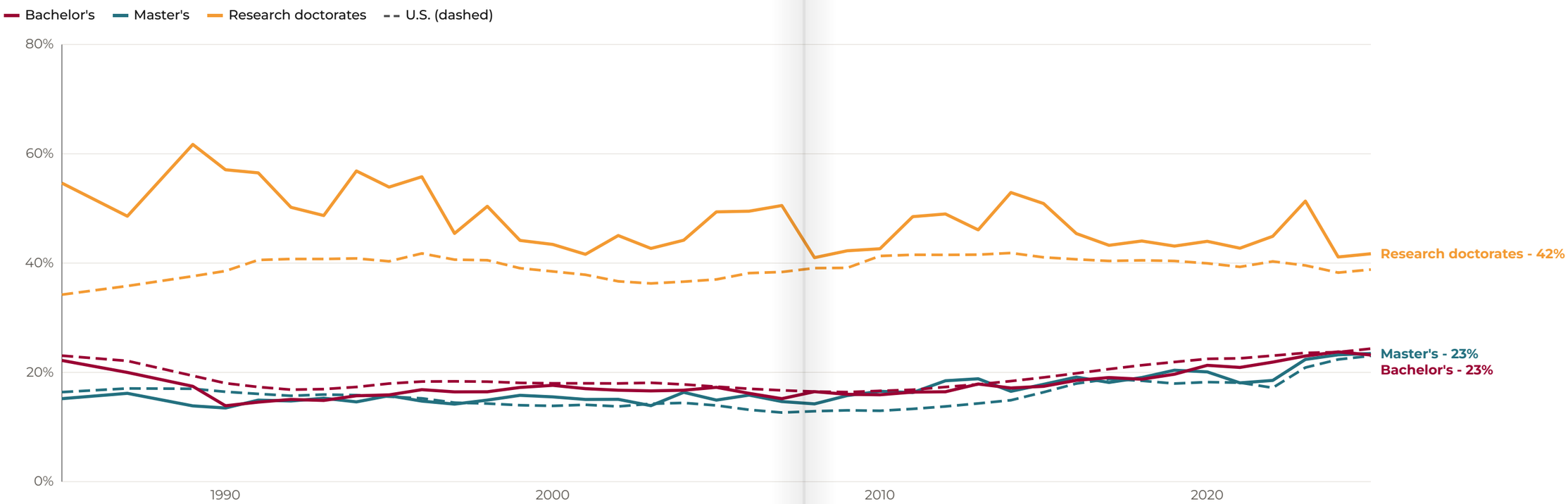
STEM master's degrees awarded in Rhode Island, all students and international students, 2015 and 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

SECTION 2

STEM Degrees

Rhode Island ranks 19th of 51 on the STEM share of master's, at 23% in 2025 against 23% for the U.S.

Figure 7 How Much of Rhode Island's Degree Output Is STEM?



STEM share of degrees by level; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

STEM fields account for 23% of Rhode Island's bachelor's degrees, 23% of its master's and 42% of its research doctorates (U.S. 24%, 23% and 39%).

The STEM share of master's degrees is up 5.6 points since 2015, and the state ranks 19th of 51 on it. On the STEM share of bachelor's degrees it ranks 25th of 51.

23%

STEM share of bachelor's, 2025

U.S. **24%** · **25th** of 51 · +5.7 pp since 2015

23%

STEM share of master's, 2025

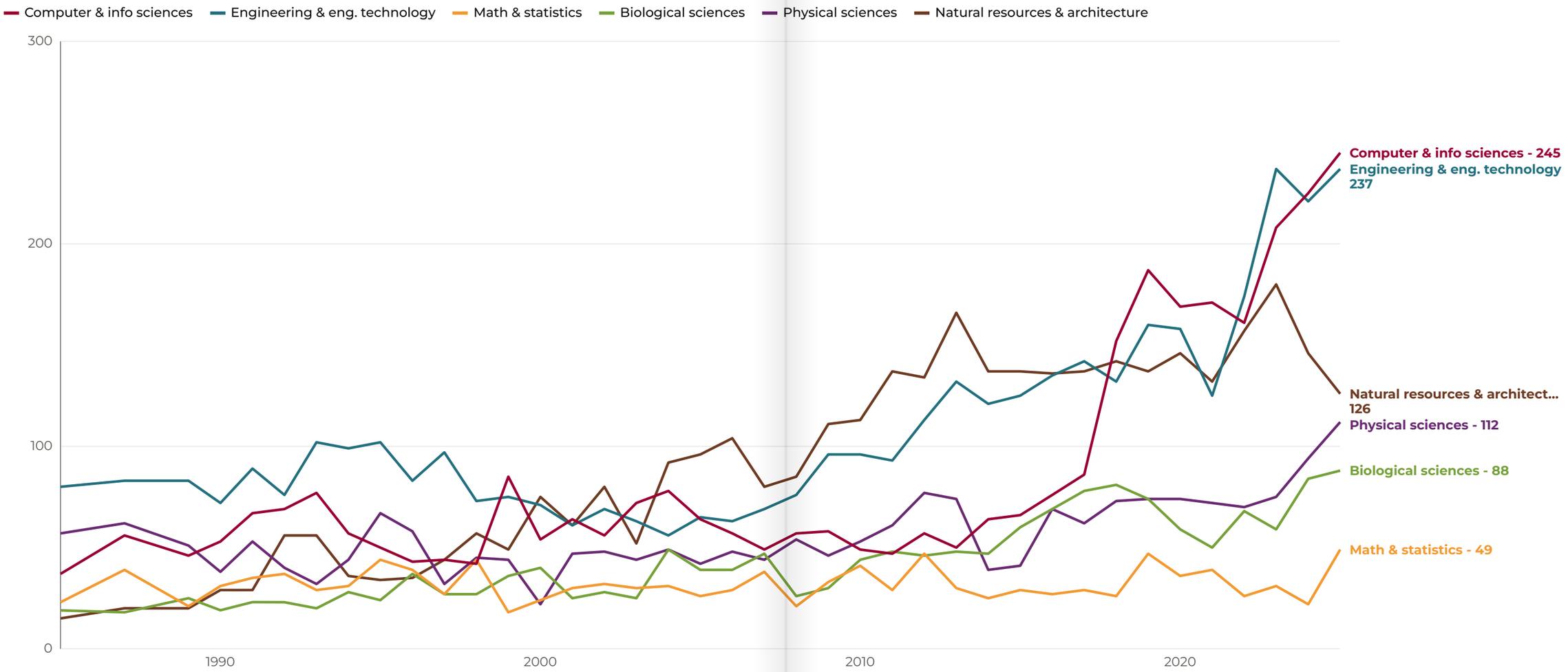
U.S. **23%** · **19th** of 51 · +5.6 pp since 2015

42%

STEM share of research doctorates, 2025

U.S. **39%** · **29th** of 51 · −9.2 pp since 2015

Figure 8 Which STEM Fields Produce Rhode Island's Master's Degrees?



STEM master's degrees by field, all students. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Computer & info sciences produced the most STEM master's degrees in 2025, 245, followed by engineering & eng. technology (237) and natural resources & architecture (126). Master's degrees in computer & info sciences are up 271% since 2015.

International students earned 406 of the state's STEM master's degrees in 2025, 0.3% of the national total (36th of 51).

406

International STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **117K** · **36th** of 51 · 2.31× since 2015

0.3%

Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025

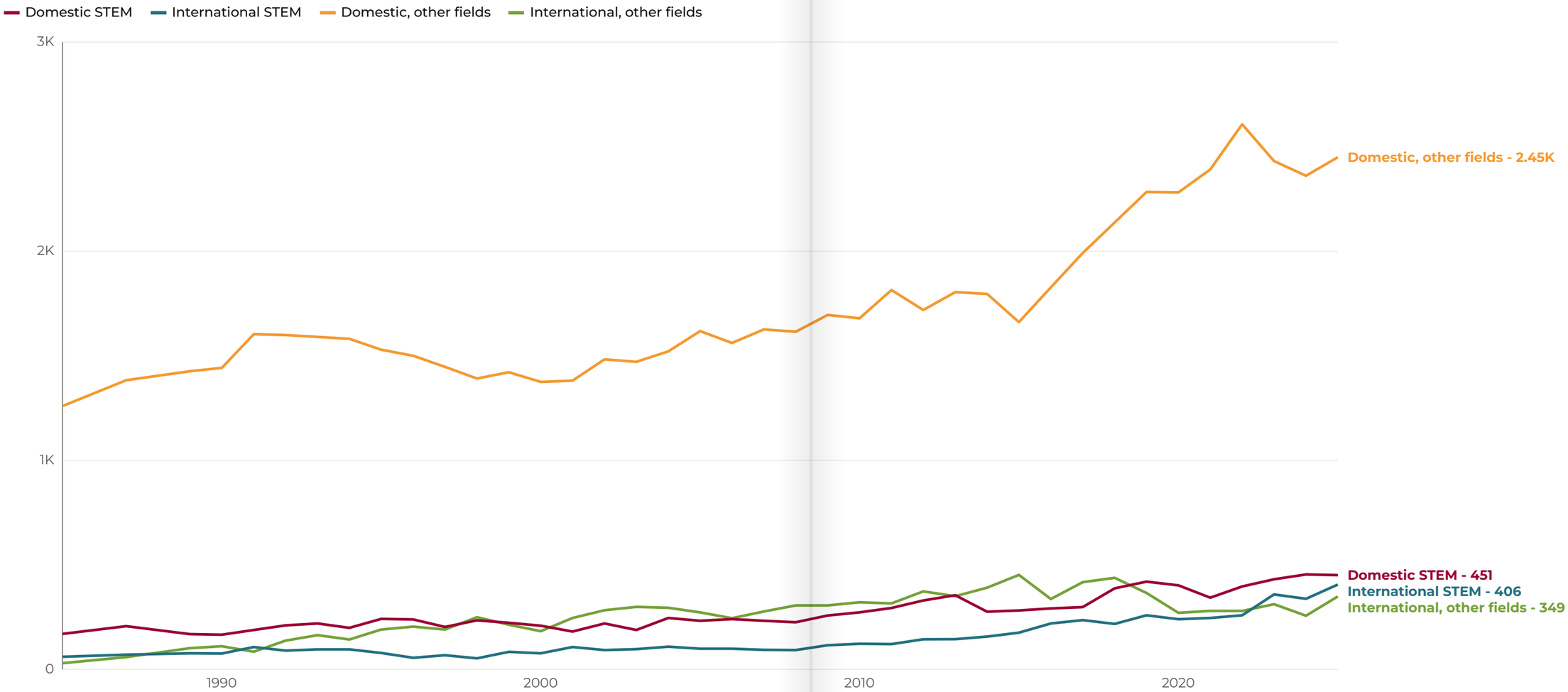
36th of 51 · 0.0 pp since 2015

52%

Int. share of CS master's, 2025

U.S. **65%** · **30th** of 47 · +9.8 pp since 2015

Figure 9 Who Earns Rhode Island's Master's Degrees?



Master's degrees by student residency and field group. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Between 2015 and 2025, 230 more STEM master's degrees went to international students and 169 more to domestic students.

International students earn 47% of Rhode Island's STEM master's but 12% of master's in other fields (U.S. 52% and 12%).

21%

Int. share of all master's, 2025
U.S. **22%** · **17th** of 51 · −3.8 pp since 2015

47%

Int. share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · **24th** of 51 · +8.9 pp since 2015

4.5

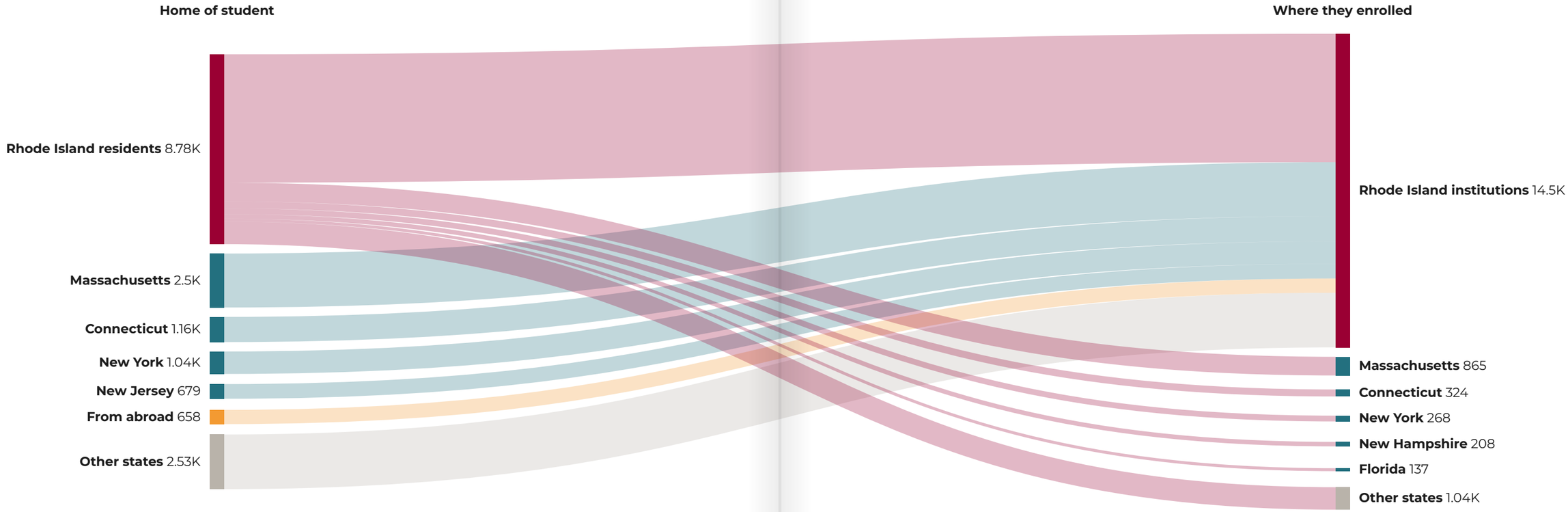
STEM master's per STEM research doctorate (IPEDS), 2025
U.S. **6.4** · **35th** of 51 · +1.8 since 2015

SECTION 3

Where Students Come From

Rhode Island ranks 3rd of 51 on net student migration, at +58 in 2024.

Figure 10 First-Time Students by Home and Destination, Fall 2024



Home of first-time degree-seeking undergraduates (left) and the state of the institution entered (right); the five largest sources and destinations (more when states tie at the printed figure), the rest grouped; ties are ordered by exact count. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

5.94K residents stayed in Rhode Island for college in fall 2024; 7.9K students arrived from other states and 658 from abroad, while 2.84K residents left.

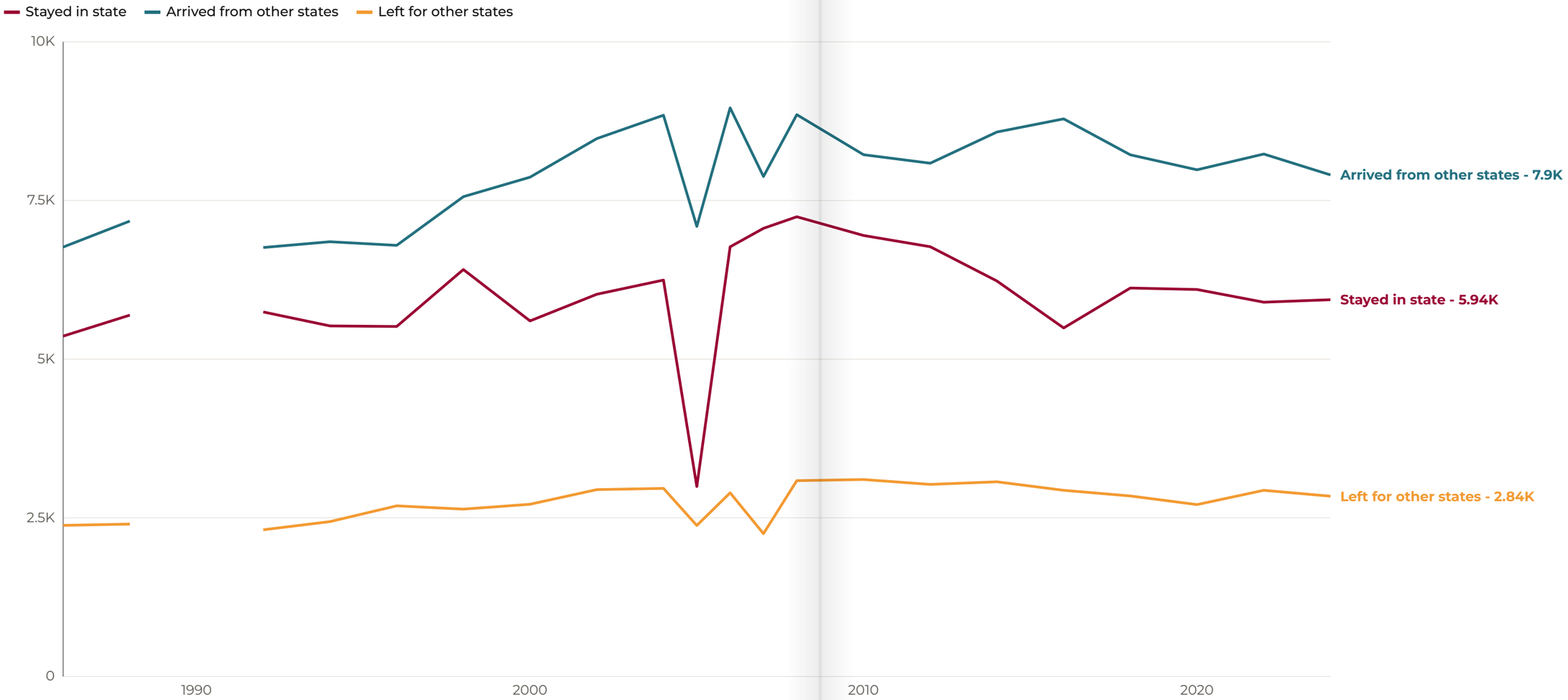
Each band runs from a student's home on the left to the state where they enrolled on the right. 41% of the state's first-time students are residents.

41%
First-time students from in state, 2024
48th of 51 · +4.0 pp since 2016

4.5%
First-time students from abroad, 2024
U.S. **3.1%** · **8th** of 51 · +0.5 pp since 2016

+58
Net migration per 100 residents, 2024
3rd of 51 · −11.8 since 2016

Figure 11 How Have the Flows Changed?



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates by flow; even years before 2001. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

Since 2015, the number of residents staying in state for college is up 8%, arrivals from other states are down 10%, and residents leaving are down 3%.

Net migration was +58 per 100 resident first-time students (3rd of 51). The top destination for residents who left was Massachusetts (865).

Figure 12

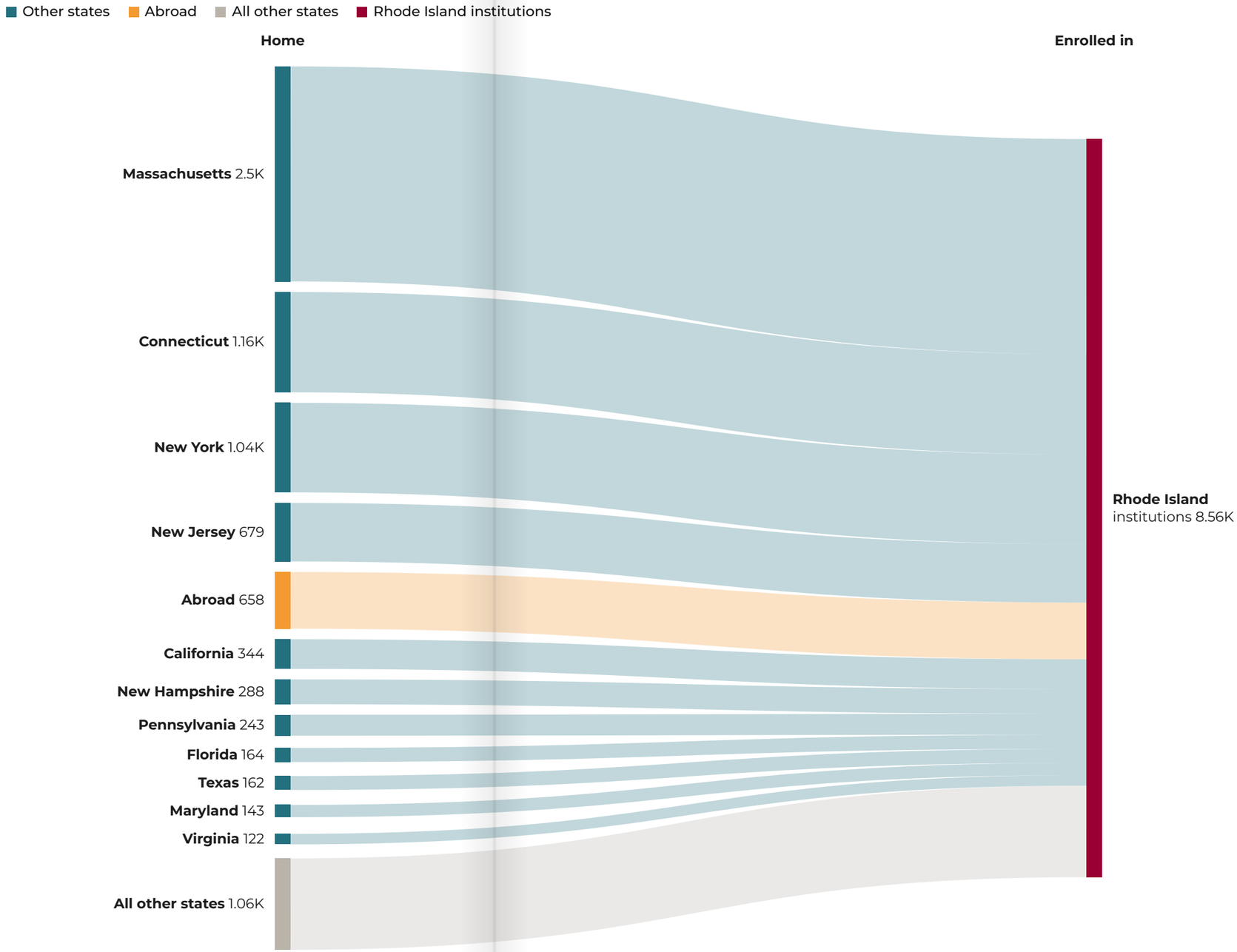
Where Do Rhode Island's Newcomers Come From?

The bands show where first-time degree-seeking undergraduates who enrolled at Rhode Island's institutions in fall 2024 but did not live in the state came from: the 12 largest home states and students from abroad, with all other states grouped. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. Home is the state where the student lived when admitted.

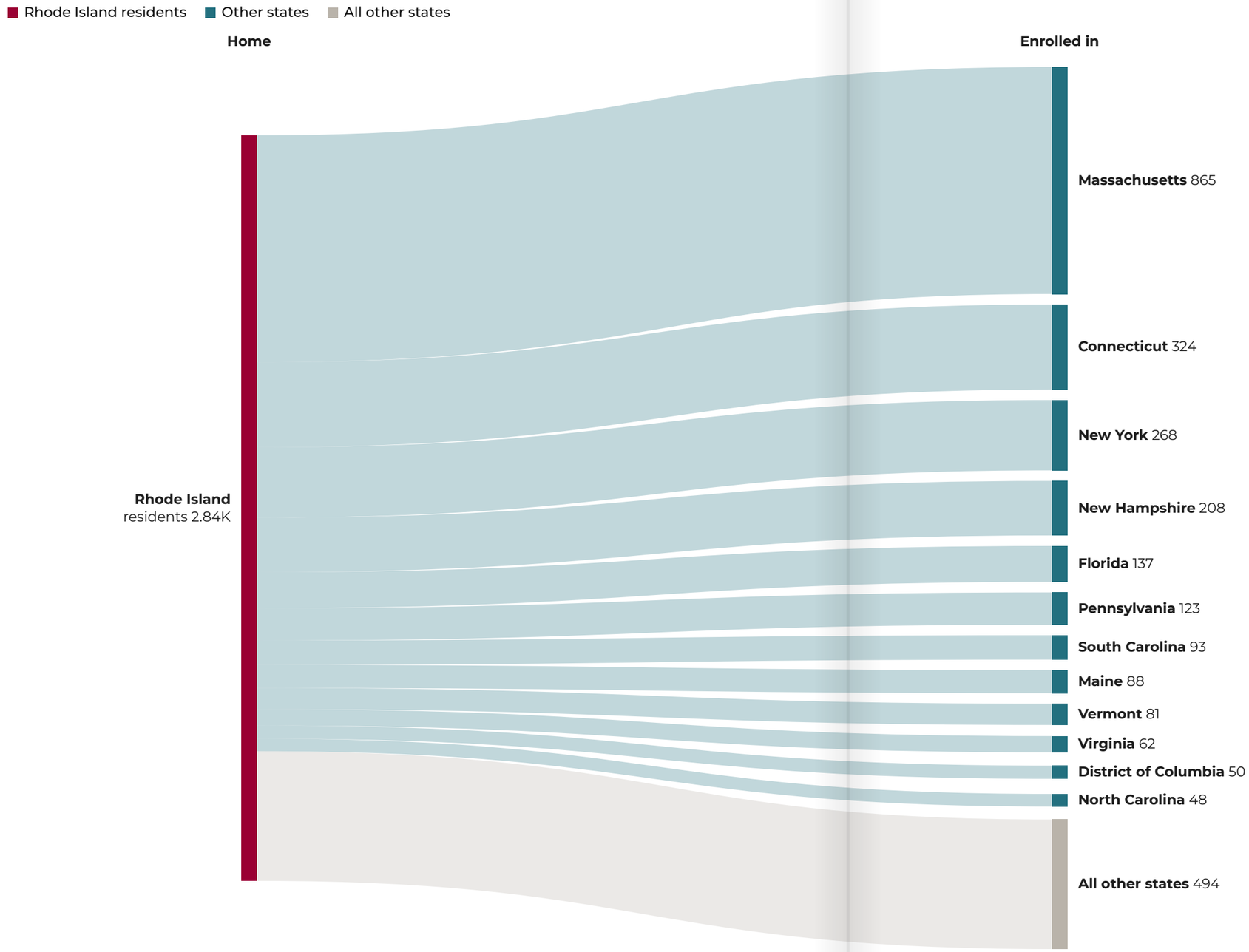
8.56K
First-time students from other states and abroad, fall 2024
Abroad **658**

4.5%
First-time students from abroad, 2024
U.S. **3.1%** · **8th** of 51 · +0.5 pp since 2016

41%
First-time students from in state, 2024
48th of 51 · +4.0 pp since 2016



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates, fall 2024; the 12 largest flows (more when states tie at the printed figure), ordered by exact count. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates, fall 2024; the 12 largest flows (more when states tie at the printed figure), ordered by exact count. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

Figure 13

Where Do Rhode Island's Residents Go When They Leave?

The bands show where Rhode Island residents who left the state to start college in fall 2024 enrolled: the 12 largest destination states, with all other states grouped. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. Residents who enrolled in the state are not shown.

Residents leaving for other states. The number was 2.84K in fall 2024, down 3.1% from 2.93K in fall 2022 and down 3.1% since fall 2016, when it was 2.93K.

2.84K
Residents who started college in another state, fall 2024
Arrived from other states **7.9K** · **8.56K** with abroad

+58
Net migration per 100 residents, 2024
3rd of 51 · −11.8 since 2016

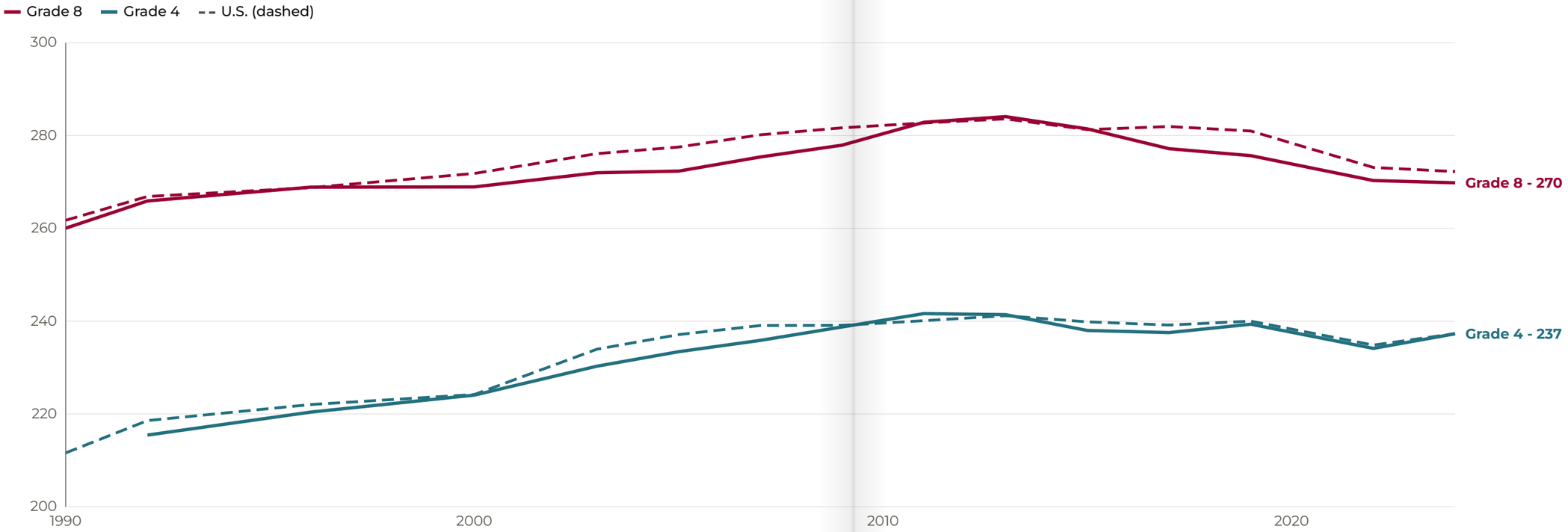
865
Went to Massachusetts
The largest destination

SECTION 4

K-12 Preparation

Rhode Island ranks 32nd of 51 on the average grade 8 mathematics score, at 270 in 2024 against 272 for the U.S.

Figure 14 How Well Prepared in Mathematics Are Rhode Island's Students?



Average NAEP mathematics score, public schools, 0–500 scale; state solid, U.S. public schools dashed. Data from NCES, National Assessment of Educational Progress.

The talent pipeline starts in school. Rhode Island's eighth graders averaged 270 in mathematics on the 2024 NAEP, against 272 for U.S. public schools, 32nd of 51 among the states.

26% scored at or above the Proficient level (U.S. 27%). Differences of a point or two are often within the margin of error.

270

Grade 8 math score (NAEP), 2024

U.S. **272** · **32nd** of 51 · −11.6 since 2015

26%

Grade 8 math, at or above Proficient, 2024

U.S. **27%** · **27th** of 51 · −5.9 pp since 2015

258

Grade 8 reading score (NAEP), 2024

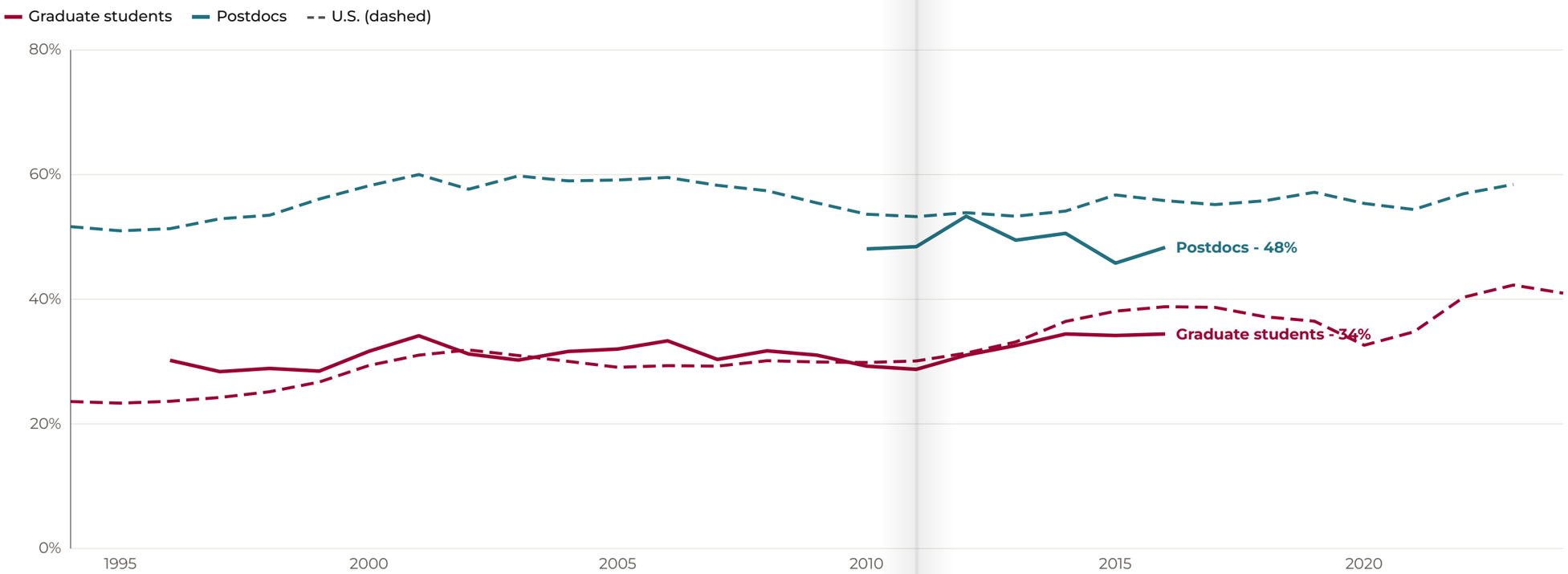
U.S. **257** · **23rd** of 51 · −7.3 since 2015

SECTION 5

Graduate Research

Rhode Island ranks 36th of 51 on research doctorates awarded, at 354 in 2025 against 59K for the U.S.

Figure 15 How Many of Rhode Island's Science and Engineering Graduate Students Hold Temporary Visas?



Temporary-visa share of science and engineering graduate students and postdoctoral appointees, by the institution's state; state solid, U.S. dashed. NSF stopped publishing state tables after 2016. Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates.

In 2016, the last year NSF published state tables, 34% of Rhode Island's science and engineering graduate students held temporary visas (U.S. 39%; 23rd of 51).

Among postdoctoral researchers, the share was 48% (U.S. 56%). Postdocs are the stage of research training most dependent on international talent, and IPEDS does not count them.

The state's institutions awarded 354 research doctorates in 2025, 0.6% of the U.S. total (Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Earned Doctorates; NSF publishes doctorates by citizenship only for the nation).

34%
S&E grad students on temporary visas, 2016
U.S. **39%** · **23rd** of 51 · +0.2 pp since 2015

48%
S&E postdocs on temporary visas, 2016
U.S. **56%** · **35th** of 51 · +2.5 pp since 2015

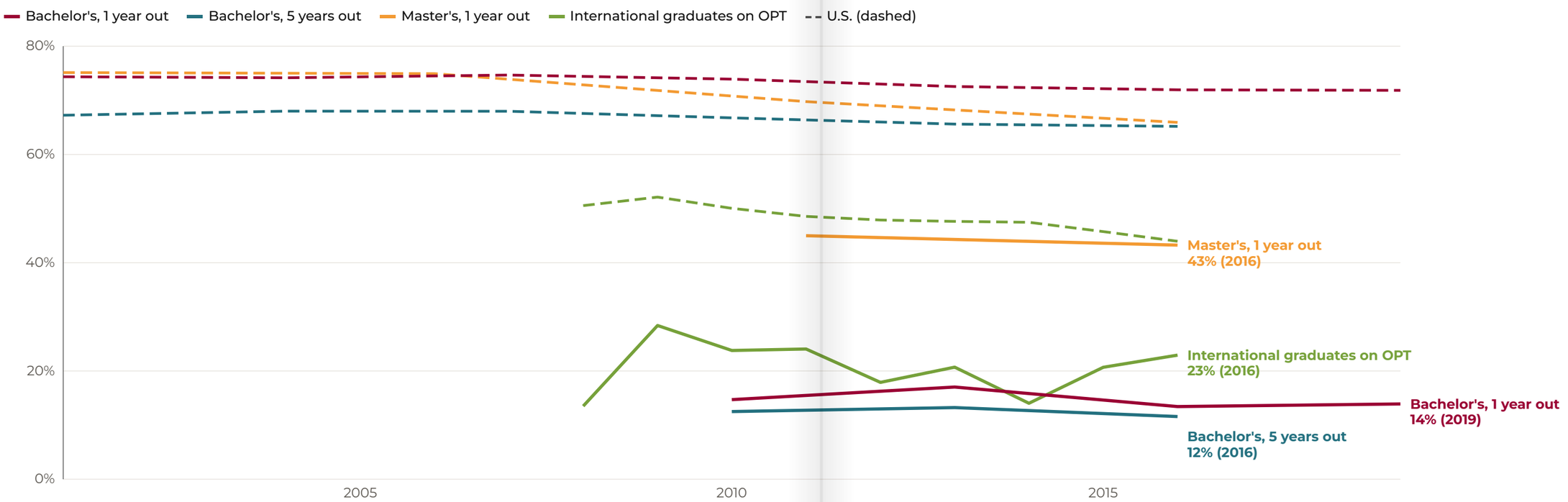
354
Research doctorates awarded (NSF SED), 2025
U.S. **59K** · **36th** of 51 · +11% since 2015

SECTION 6

Do Graduates Stay?

Rhode Island ranks 33rd of 33 on the share of bachelor's graduates working in the state 1 year after graduating, at 14% in 2019 against 72% for the U.S.

Figure 16 How Many of Rhode Island's Graduates Go On to Work in the State?



Share of employed graduates working in the state of their institution, by graduating cohort (Data from U.S. Census Bureau, Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes; participating institutions only); international graduates' OPT jobs in the state where they studied (Data from ICE, SEVIS FOIA releases; shares only, the file is truncated). State solid, U.S. or participating states dashed.

Of Rhode Island's bachelor's graduates who were working a year after graduating, 14% worked in the state (participating states 72%). Five years out the share was 12%.

Among international graduates on Optional Practical Training in 2016, 23% worked in the state where they studied (U.S. 44%). That is the last year the released records cover, before most of the growth in international STEM master's degrees since 2015. Through migration between states, the state gained 0.7 bachelor's-plus adults per 1,000 such residents in 2025 (Data from U.S. Census Bureau, American Community Survey).

14%

Bachelor's grads working in-state, 1 year out, 2019

U.S. **72%** · **33rd** of 33 · +0.5 pp since 2016

23%

OPT graduates working in the state, 2016

U.S. **44%** · **44th** of 51 · +2.2 pp since 2015

+0.7

Net migration, bachelor's-plus, per 1,000, 2025

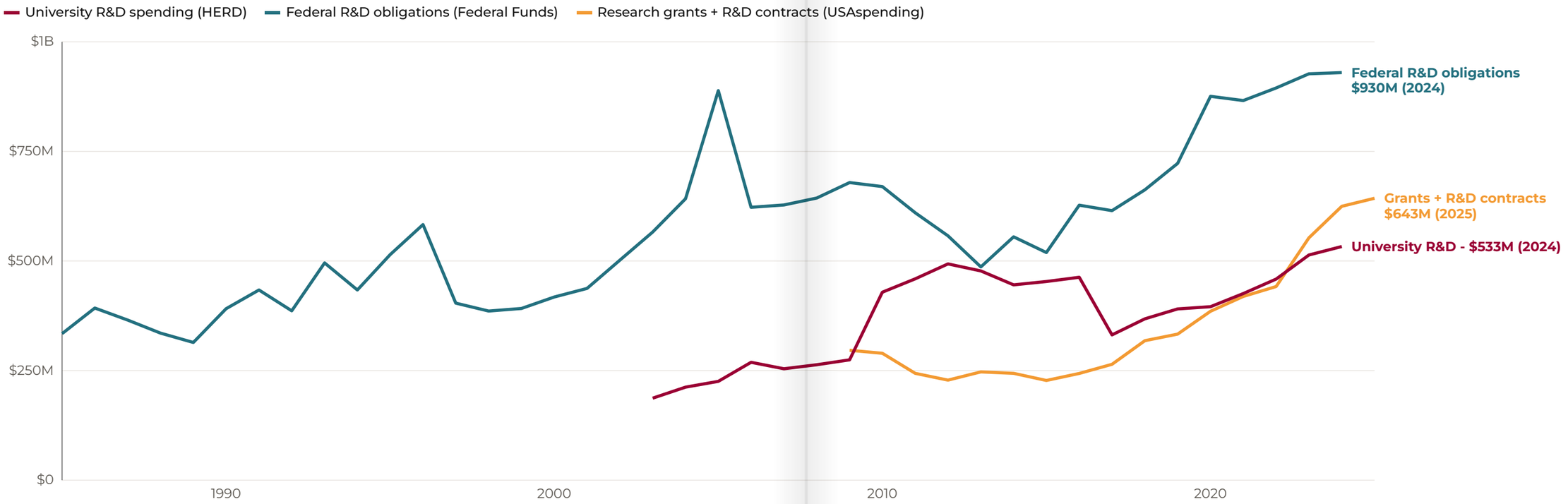
27th of 51 · −1.0 since 2015

SECTION 7

Research Funding

Rhode Island ranks 3rd of 51 on the federally funded share of university R&D, at 71% in 2024 against 55% for the U.S.

Figure 17 How Much Research Money Flows Into Rhode Island?



Nominal dollars (not adjusted for inflation), fiscal years; a line ending before the others is labeled with its last year. University R&D: Data from NSF NCSES, Higher Education Research and Development Survey (FY2003-09 predecessor survey). Federal R&D obligations by state of performance: Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Federal Funds for R&D (coverage widens in FY2021). Grants from NSF, NIH, NASA and DOE Science plus R&D contracts: Data from USAspending.gov.

Rhode Island's universities spent $533M on research and development in FY2024, 38th of 51 among the states; 71% of it was federally funded (U.S. 55%).

Federal agencies obligated $930M for R&D performed in the state in FY2024. Research funding drives demand for graduate students and postdocs, the stage of training most dependent on international talent.

$533M
University R&D spending, 2024
U.S. **$118B** · **38th** of 51 · +18% since 2015

71%
Federal share of university R&D, 2024
U.S. **55%** · **3rd** of 51 · +24.8 pp since 2015

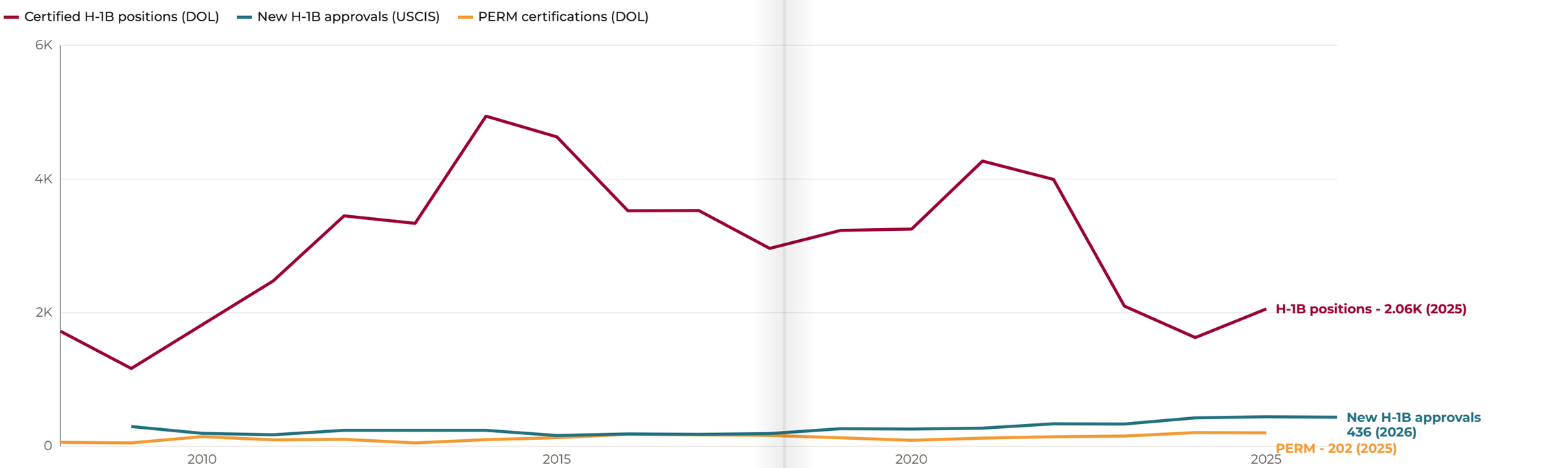
$930M
Federal R&D obligations, 2024
U.S. **$193B** · **29th** of 51 · +79% since 2015

SECTION 8

H-1B Jobs and Green Cards

Rhode Island ranks 49th of 51 on the share of PERM certifications for workers on F-1 student visas, at 2.6% in 2024 against 8.7% for the U.S.

Figure 18 How Many Skilled-Visa Jobs and Green-Card Certifications Does Rhode Island Generate?



Certified H-1B positions on labor condition applications by worksite and certified PERM green-card applications, by fiscal year (Data from DOL, Office of Foreign Labor Certification); new H-1B petition approvals by the employer's address (Data from USCIS, H-1B Employer Data Hub).

Employers were certified for 2.06K H-1B positions at Rhode Island worksites in FY2025, 37th of 51 among the states. A labor condition application comes before the petition and covers renewals and job changes as well as new hires, by the worksite's state, so it runs well above approvals. USCIS approved 436 new H-1B petitions in FY2026 and 1.65K continuing ones, counted by the employer's address.

DOL certified 202 PERM applications, the employer's step toward an employment-based green card, for jobs in the state in FY2025. In FY2024, 2.6% were for workers still on F-1 student visas (U.S. 8.7%): the most direct link from classroom to permanent residence.

2.06K

Certified H-1B positions (worksite), 2025

U.S. **914K** · **37th** of 51 · −56% since 2015

202

PERM green-card certifications, 2025

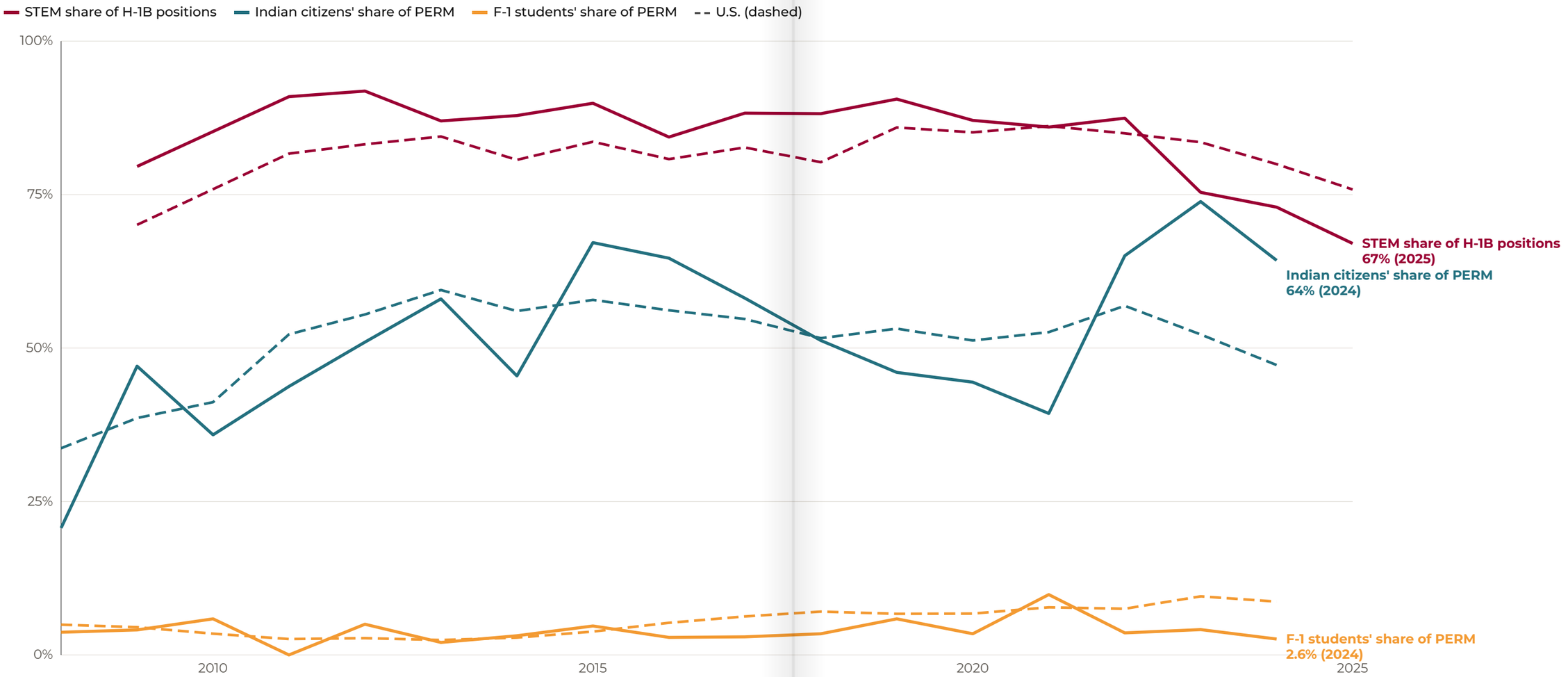
U.S. **138K** · **43rd** of 51 · +58% since 2015

2.6%

PERM workers on F-1 student visas, 2024

U.S. **8.7%** · **49th** of 51 · −2.1 pp since 2015

Figure 19 Who Holds Rhode Island's Skilled-Visa Jobs?



State solid, U.S. dashed. PERM citizenship and class of admission are not on the form DOL uses from FY2025. Data from DOL, Office of Foreign Labor Certification.

67% of the state's certified H-1B positions were in STEM occupations in FY2025 (U.S. 76%).

Citizens of India held 64% of the state's PERM certifications in FY2024 (U.S. 47%). Under per-country caps they face the longest waits for a green card, so this share measures the state's exposure to the backlog.

67%

STEM share of H-1B positions, 2025

U.S. **76%** · **25th** of 51 · −22.8 pp since 2015

64%

PERM certifications for Indian citizens, 2024

U.S. **47%** · **3rd** of 51 · −2.9 pp since 2015

$110K

Median offered H-1B wage (nominal), 2025

U.S. **$119K** · **14th** of 51 · +55% since 2015

SECTION 9

STEM Workforce

Rhode Island ranks 35th of 44 on the foreign-born share of STEM workers with a graduate degree, at 22% in 2024 against 41% for the U.S.

Figure 20 How Much of Rhode Island's STEM Workforce Was Born Abroad?



Foreign-born share of employed workers in STEM occupations, by state of residence; state solid, U.S. dashed. Shares resting on fewer than 100 survey records are left out. No 2020 (experimental data). Data from U.S. Census Bureau, American Community Survey.

In 2024, 15% of the people working in STEM occupations in Rhode Island were born abroad (U.S. 24%; 22nd of 51).

The share rises with education: 22% of STEM workers with a graduate degree were foreign-born (U.S. 41%). 7.1% of all STEM workers were not U.S. citizens.

15%

Foreign-born share of STEM workers, 2024

U.S. **24%** · **22nd** of 51 · −0.3 pp since 2015

22%

Foreign-born, STEM workers with grad degrees, 2024

U.S. **41%** · **35th** of 44 · −2.3 pp since 2017

7.1%

Noncitizen share of STEM workers, 2024

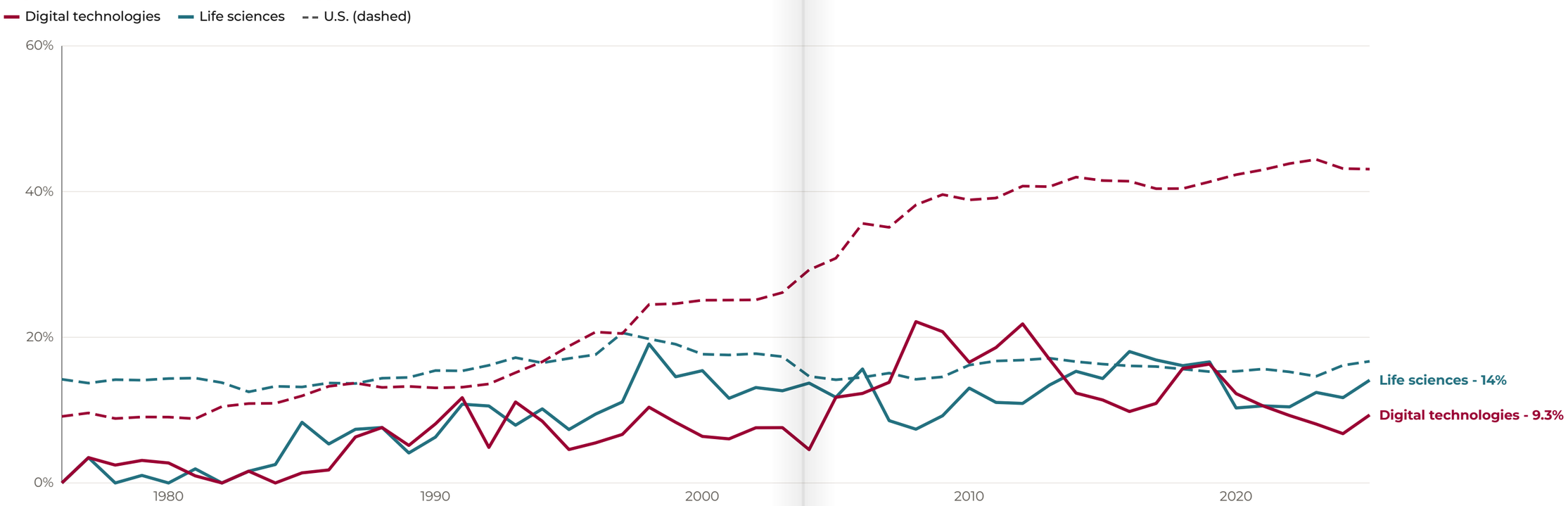
U.S. **11%** · **24th** of 51 · −2.5 pp since 2015

SECTION 10

Patents

Rhode Island ranks 44th of 51 on the share of the state's patents in digital technologies, at 9.3% in 2025 against 43% for the U.S.

Figure 21 What Kinds of Technology Does Rhode Island Patent?



Share of patents granted to owners in the state, by WIPO technology field of the first classification; state solid, U.S. dashed. Fractional counts by the owner's (assignee's) location, not where inventors live. Data from USPTO, PatentsView.

Organizations and people in Rhode Island were granted 410 U.S. patents in 2025, 0.3% of all patents with a U.S. owner (34th of 51).

9.3% were in digital technologies (U.S. 43%) and 14% in the life sciences (U.S. 17%).

410

Patents granted to owners in the state, 2025

U.S. **135K** · **34th** of 51 · +53% since 2015

9.3%

Patents in digital technologies, 2025

U.S. **43%** · **44th** of 51 · −2.1 pp since 2015

14%

Patents in life sciences, 2025

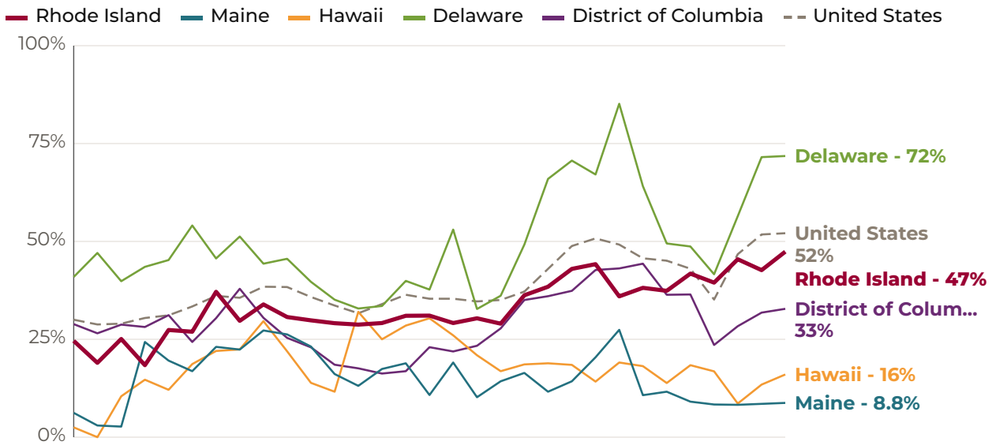
U.S. **17%** · **32nd** of 51 · −0.2 pp since 2015

SECTION 11

Competitors

The four states closest in total fall enrollment, measured proportionally (a state 1.5 times as large counts as near as one two-thirds the size), are Maine, Hawaii, Delaware, and District of Columbia. Rhode Island ranks 2nd of the five on the international share of STEM master's; Delaware is the most dependent at 72%.

Figure 22 How Dependent Are Rhode Island and Its Peers on International STEM Master's?



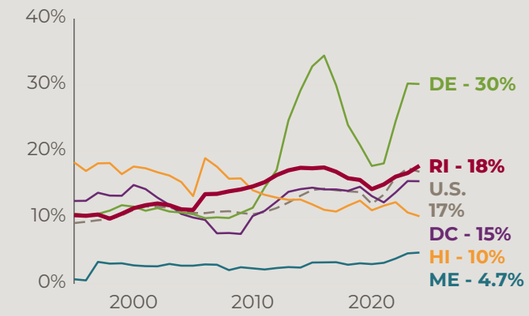
Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Table 4 How Does Rhode Island Compare With States of Similar Size?

Measure	RI	ME	HI	DE	DC	U.S.
Students enrolled, 2024	**75.6K**	80.9K	61.4K	57.8K	100K	19.7M
Graduate share of students, 2024	**16%**	12%	12%	18%	42%	17%
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025	**23%**	24%	20%	22%	16%	24%
STEM share of master's, 2025	**23%**	13%	17%	38%	17%	23%
International STEM master's, 2025	**406**	28	40	1.03K	656	117K
Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025	**0.3%**	0.0%	0.0%	0.9%	0.6%	–
Int. share of STEM master's, 2025	**47%**	8.8%	16%	72%	33%	52%
Int. share of STEM research doctorates, 2025	**38%**	39%	35%	52%	36%	43%
Int. share of grad students, 2024	**18%**	4.7%	10%	30%	15%	17%
Int. share of undergraduate enrollment, 2024	**5.7%**	2.3%	6.2%	3.5%	5.6%	3.0%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024	**74%**	60%	56%	72%	79%	65%
In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023	**$15.5K**	$11.4K	$10.4K	$11.8K	$6.33K	$9.71K
Appropriations per student, 2024	**$8.67K**	$10.2K	$16.9K	$8.9K	$44K	$11.4K
Average faculty salary, 2024	**$120K**	$93.7K	$110K	$123K	$132K	$106K
First-time students from in state, 2024	**41%**	63%	73%	58%	10%	–
Net migration per 100 residents, 2024	**+58**	+16	−21	+7	+162	–

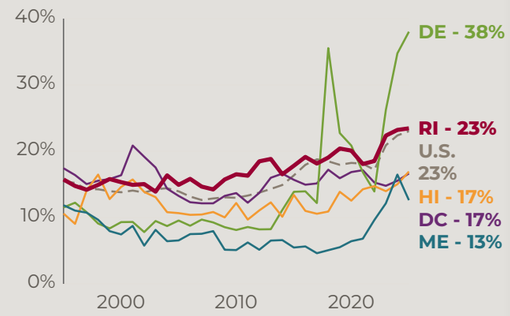
Latest year for each measure, given after its name. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 23 Int. share of grad students



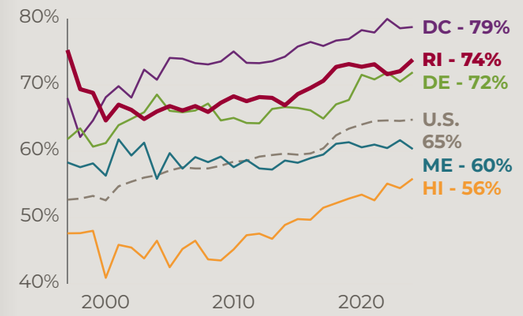
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 24 STEM share of master's



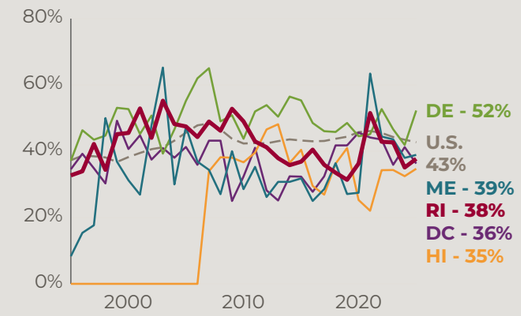
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 25 Six-year graduation rate



Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 26 Int. share of STEM doctorates

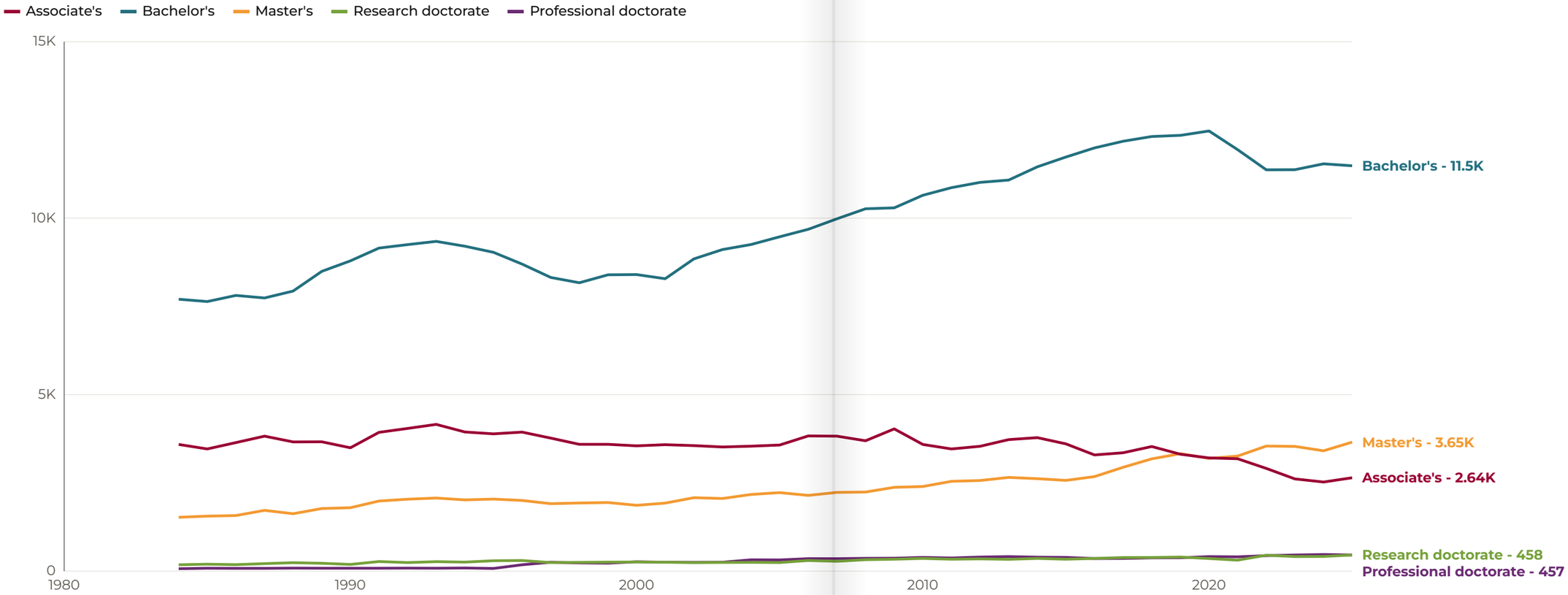


Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 12

Fields of Study

Figure 27 How Many Degrees Does Rhode Island Award?

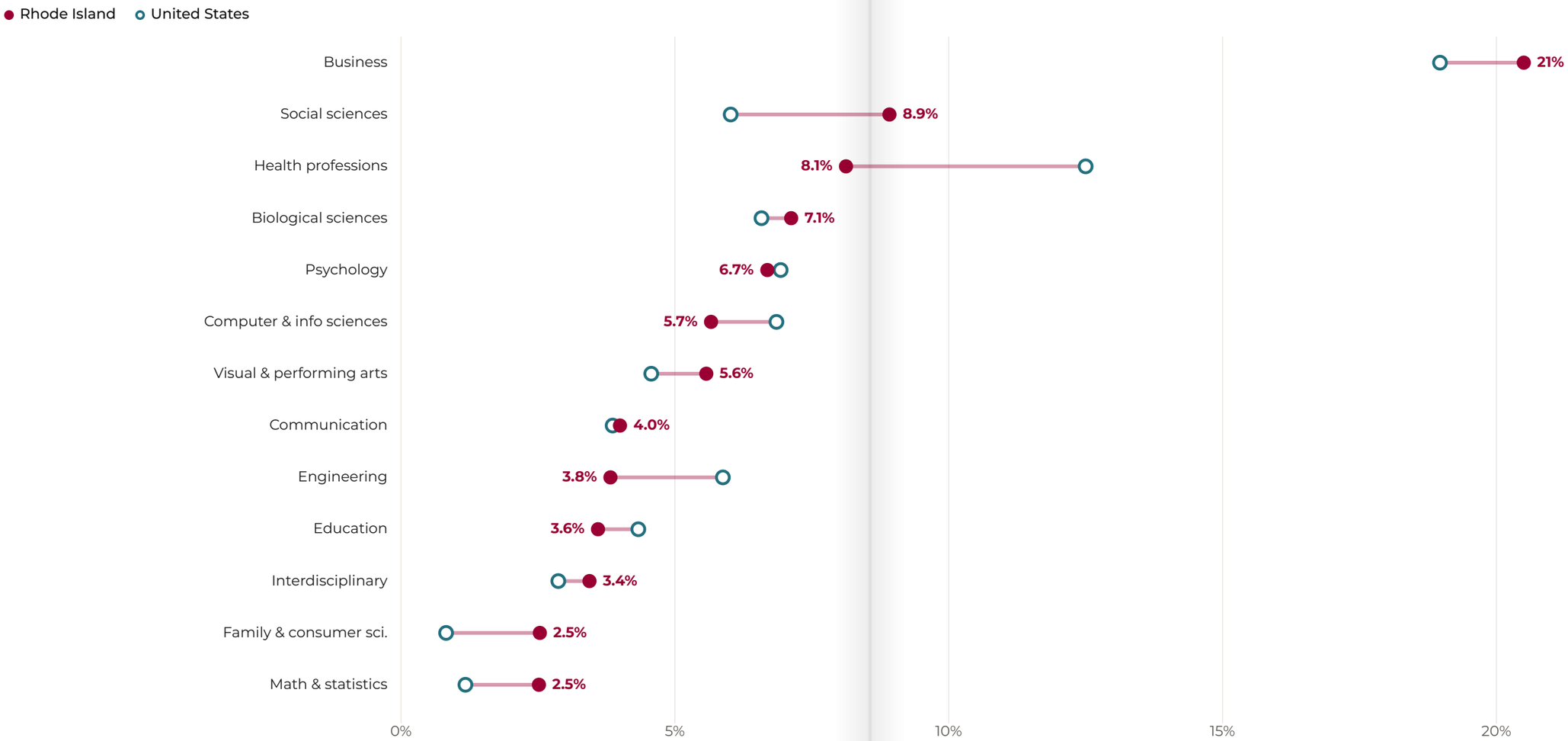


Degrees awarded by level, first majors. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

In 2025, Rhode Island's institutions awarded 2.64K associate's degrees, 11.5K bachelor's degrees, 3.65K master's degrees, 458 research doctorate degrees, 457 professional doctorate degrees.

Since 2015: associate's down 27%; bachelor's down 2%; master's up 42%; research doctorate up 36%; professional doctorate up 18%. The state awards 18.0 bachelor's degrees for every 100 undergraduates (U.S. 12.3).

Figure 28 What Do Rhode Island's Bachelor's Graduates Study?



Share of bachelor's degrees by field, 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Rhode Island's largest bachelor's fields are business (21%; U.S. 19%), social sciences (8.9%; U.S. 6.0%), health professions (8.1%; U.S. 13%).

Relative to the nation, Rhode Island's bachelor's degrees are most concentrated in personal & culinary (42.55× the U.S. share), family & consumer sci. (3.08× the U.S. share), math & statistics (2.14× the U.S. share).

5.7%

Bachelor's in computer science, 2025

U.S. **6.9%** · **26th** of 51 · +2.7 pp since 2015

4.1%

Bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology, 2025

U.S. **6.8%** · **45th** of 51 · 0.0 pp since 2015

20%

Bachelor's in business, 2025

U.S. **19%** · **19th** of 51 · −2.3 pp since 2015

Figure 29 What Do Rhode Island's Master's Graduates Study?



Share of master's degrees by field, 2025; largest fields. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Rhode Island's largest master's fields are business (21%; U.S. 21%), health professions (15%; U.S. 15%), education (8.7%; U.S. 15%).

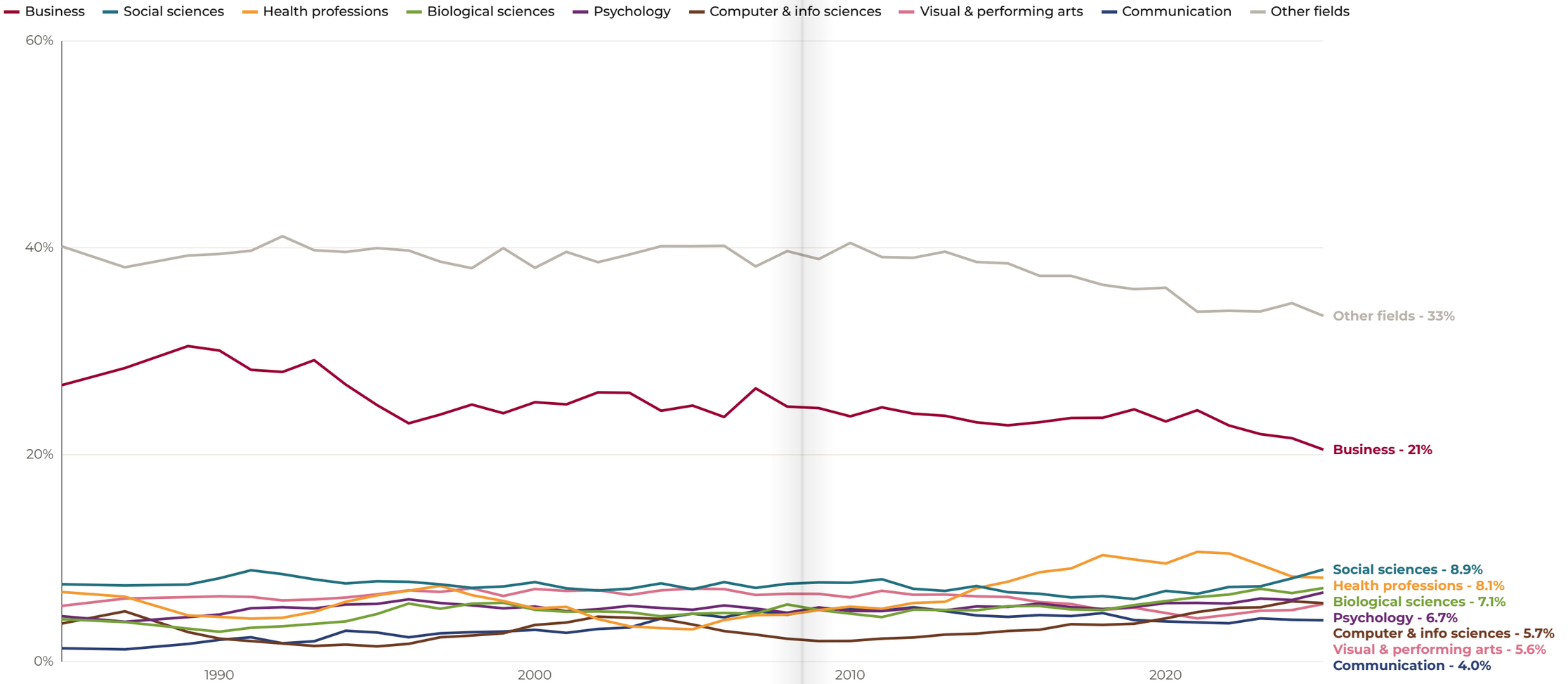
International students earn 21% of all master's degrees in the state (U.S. 22%), and STEM fields account for 23% of them.

23%
STEM share of master's, 2025
U.S. **23%** · **19th** of 51 · +5.6 pp since 2015

21%
Int. share of all master's, 2025
U.S. **22%** · **17th** of 51 · −3.8 pp since 2015

52%
Int. share of CS master's, 2025
U.S. **65%** · **30th** of 47 · +9.8 pp since 2015

Figure 30 How Has Rhode Island's Bachelor's Field Mix Changed?



Share of bachelor's degrees in the largest fields. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Since 2015, computer & info sciences has gained the most ground, 2.7 points of the state's bachelor's degrees, while business lost the most (2.4 points).

The chart follows the share of bachelor's degrees in each of the state's largest fields; smaller fields are grouped as other fields.

SECTION 12 · FIELDS OF STUDY

Where Is Rhode Island Most Specialized?

The location quotient divides a field's share of Rhode Island's bachelor's degrees by its share of all U.S. bachelor's degrees in 2025. A quotient of 1.00 means the same share as the nation; 2.00 means twice the national share. The table lists the 10 fields with the highest quotients among fields with at least 50 degrees.

Highest location quotients. Personal & culinary (42.55, with 1.4% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 0.0% for the U.S.), family & consumer sci. (3.08, with 2.5% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 0.8% for the U.S.), and math & statistics (2.14, with 2.5% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 1.2% for the U.S.) had the highest quotients.

Table 5 Where Is Rhode Island Most Specialized?

Field	Location quotient	State share	U.S. share	Degrees
Personal & culinary	**42.55**	1.4%	0.0%	156
Family & consumer sci.	**3.08**	2.5%	0.8%	291
Math & statistics	**2.14**	2.5%	1.2%	289
Architecture	**1.95**	1.1%	0.6%	127
Languages	**1.85**	1.1%	0.6%	123
Natural resources	**1.71**	1.9%	1.1%	219
Social sciences	**1.48**	8.9%	6.0%	1.02K
Visual & performing arts	**1.22**	5.6%	4.6%	640
English	**1.21**	1.8%	1.5%	209
Interdisciplinary	**1.20**	3.4%	2.9%	395

Bachelor's degrees; location quotient = state share ÷ U.S. share; fields with 50+ degrees. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

23%
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025
U.S. **24%** · **25th** of 51

5.7%
Bachelor's in computer science, 2025
U.S. **6.9%** · **26th** of 51

4.1%
Bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology, 2025
U.S. **6.8%** · **45th** of 51

Engineering & eng. technology. The share was 4.1% in 2025, against 6.8% for the U.S., 45th among the states, down 0.5 points from 4.6% in 2024 and unchanged since 2015, when it was 4.1%.

Health professions. The share was 8.1% in 2025, against 12% for the U.S., 48th among the states, down 0.1 points from 8.2% in 2024 and up 0.4 points since 2015, when it was 7.7%.

Table 6 Rhode Island at a Glance

Measure	2015	Previous	Latest	Change	U.S.	Rank
STEM share of bachelor's	17%	24% 2024	**23% 2025**	+5.7 pp	24%	25th
Bachelor's in computer science	3.0%	5.8% 2024	**5.7% 2025**	+2.7 pp	6.9%	26th
Bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology	4.1%	4.6% 2024	**4.1% 2025**	0.0 pp	6.8%	45th
Bachelor's in business	23%	22% 2024	**20% 2025**	−2.3 pp	19%	19th

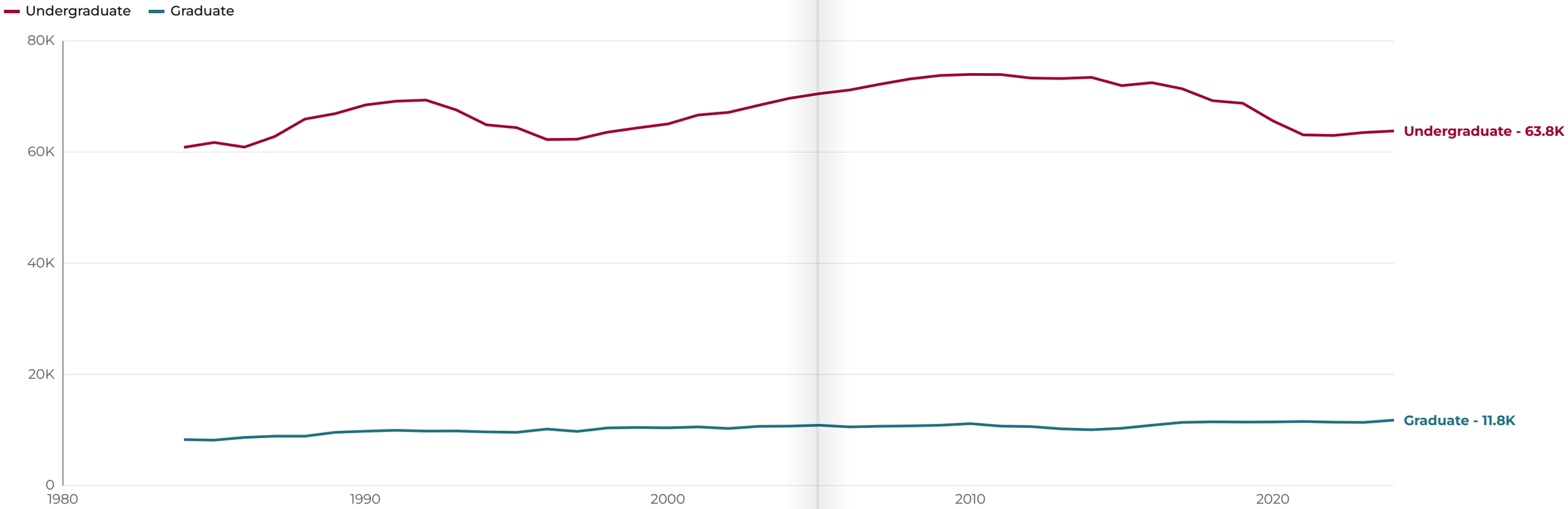
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 13

Students and Money

Rhode Island ranks 51st of 51 on the share of students enrolled part-time, at 23% in 2024 against 39% for the U.S.

Figure 31 How Has Enrollment Changed?



Fall headcount enrollment. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

In fall 2024, Rhode Island enrolled 63.8K undergraduates and 11.8K graduate students, 75.6K in all (43rd of 51).

Undergraduate enrollment is down 11% since 2015 and graduate enrollment up 14% since 2015. Graduate students are 16% of all students (U.S. 17%).

75.6K
Students enrolled, 2024
U.S. **19.7M** · **43rd** of 51 · −8.1% since 2015

16%
Graduate share of students, 2024
U.S. **17%** · **25th** of 51 · +3.0 pp since 2015

23%
Students attending part-time, 2024
U.S. **39%** · **51st** of 51 · −2.3 pp since 2015

SECTION 13 · STUDENTS AND MONEY

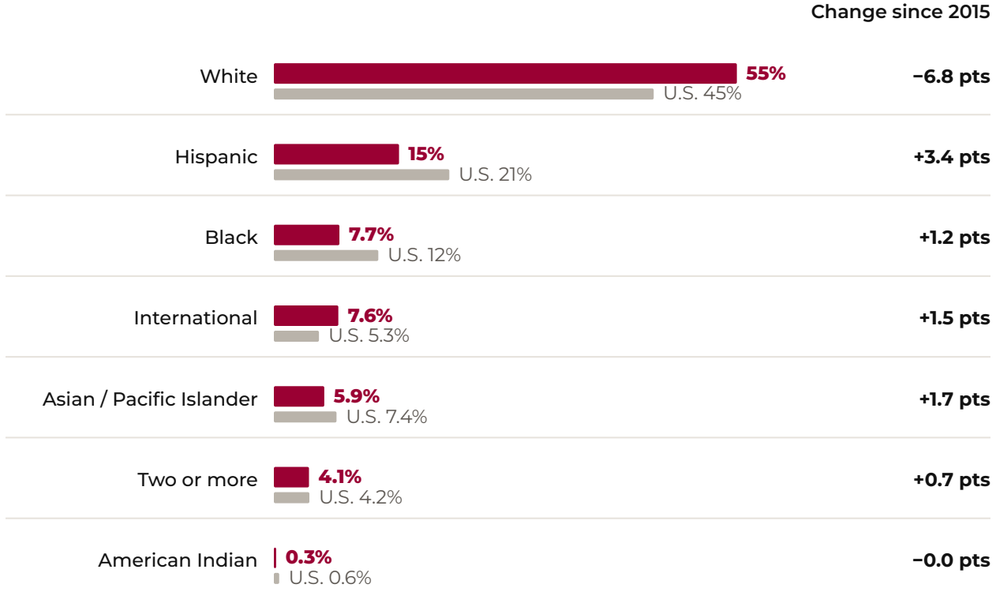
Who Enrolls in Rhode Island, and Where?

In fall 2024, White students were the largest group at Rhode Island's degree-granting institutions, **55%** of enrollment against 45% nationally, down 6.8 points since 2015.

Hispanic students were **15%** (U.S. 21%), up 3.4 points since 2015, and Black students were **7.7%** (U.S. 12%), up 1.2 points since 2015.

International students were **7.6%** (U.S. 5.3%), up 1.5 points since 2015, and Asian and Pacific Islander students were **5.9%** (U.S. 7.4%), up 1.7 points since 2015. "International" counts U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas, whatever their race.

Figure 32 Who Enrolls in Rhode Island?



Share of fall 2024 headcount enrollment by race and ethnicity; students of unknown race are left out of the chart. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

55%
White students
U.S. **45%** · −6.8 pp since 2015

15%
Hispanic students
U.S. **21%** · +3.4 pp since 2015

53%
At private nonprofit institutions
+3.1 pp since 2015

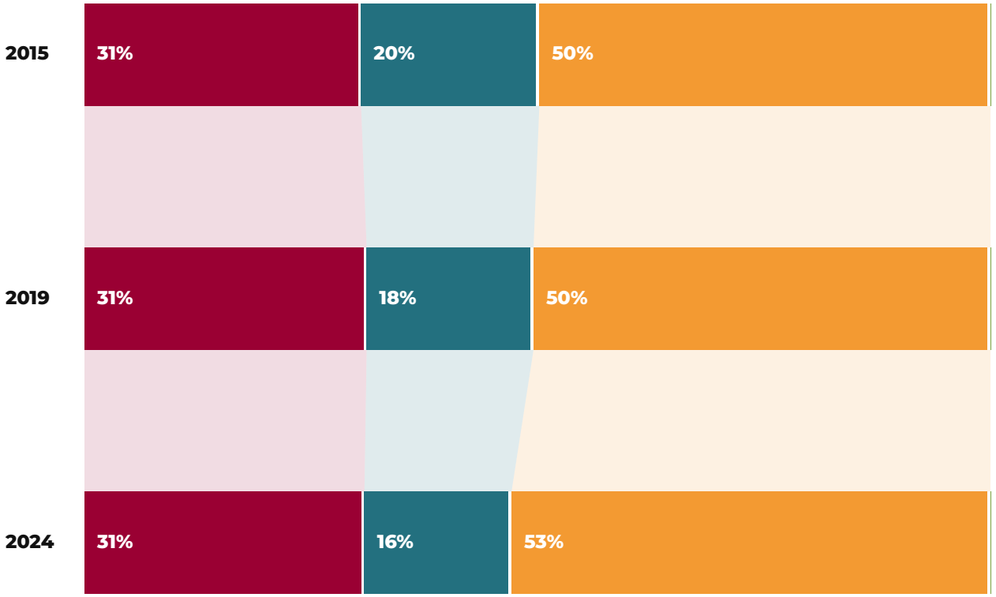
31%
At public 4-year institutions
+0.4 pp since 2015

In fall 2024, private nonprofit institutions enrolled **53%** of students, up 3.1 points from 50% in 2015. Public 4-year institutions enrolled **31%** of students, up 0.4 points from 31% in 2015.

Public 2-year institutions enrolled **16%** of students, down 3.4 points from 20% in 2015, and for-profit institutions enrolled none of the state's students.

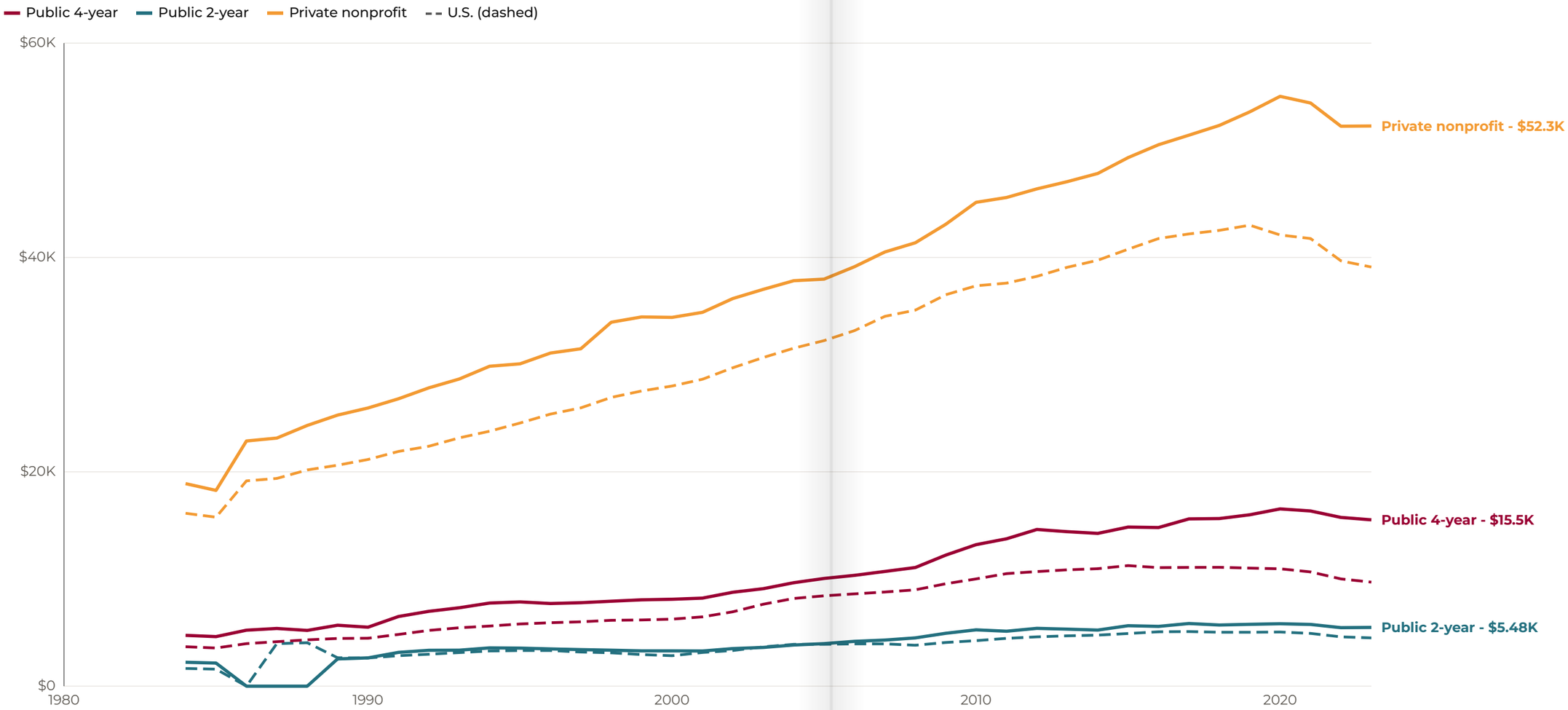
Public institutions together enrolled **47%** of students, against 73% nationally, 47th among the states.

Figure 33 Where Do Students Enroll?



Share of fall headcount enrollment by sector, 2015, 2019, 2024. Sectors as IPEDS classifies them each year. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 34 What Does In-State Tuition Cost?



Published in-state tuition and fees, 2024 dollars (CPI-U); state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

In-state tuition and fees at Rhode Island's public four-year institutions are $15.5K (2023, 2024 dollars), 60% above the U.S. ($9.71K); the state ranks 7th of 51.

State and local appropriations come to $8.67K per full-time-equivalent student at public institutions (42nd of 51), and net tuition makes up 59% of net tuition plus state and local appropriations (U.S. 43%).

$15.5K

In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023

U.S. **$9.71K** · **7th** of 51 · +4.6% since 2015

$8.67K

Appropriations per student, 2024

U.S. **$11.4K** · **42nd** of 51 · +28% since 2015

59%

Tuition share of tuition plus appropriations, 2024

U.S. **43%** · **9th** of 51 · −4.8 pp since 2015

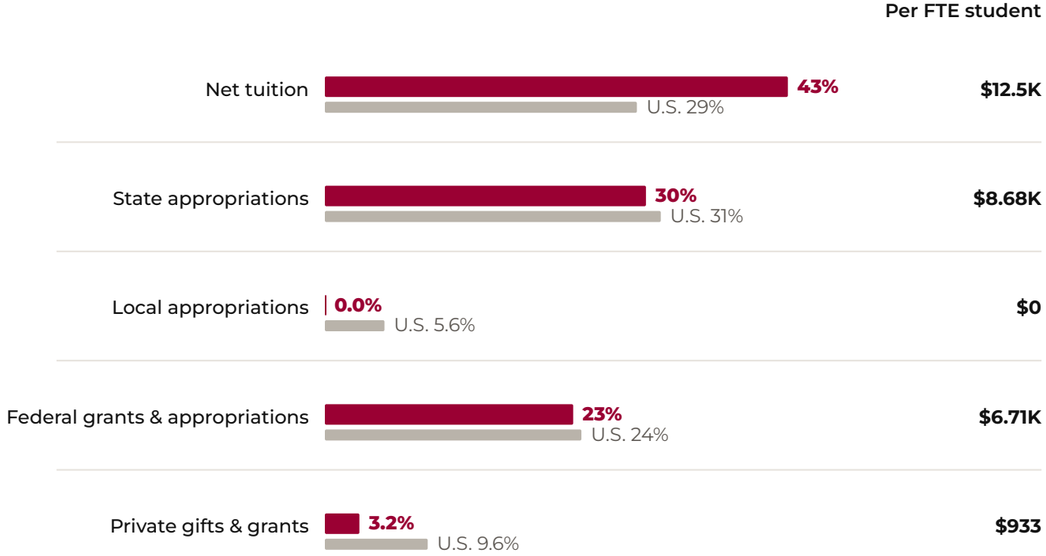
SECTION 13 · STUDENTS AND MONEY

How Are Rhode Island's Public Institutions Funded, and What Do They Produce?

The bars give each source's share of the core revenue of Rhode Island's public institutions, with the nation for comparison, and at right the dollars per full-time-equivalent (FTE) student it provides. Values are in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Net tuition is tuition and fees after institutional discounts and allowances.

Net tuition per FTE student. The figure was $12.5K in FY2024, against $8.96K for the U.S., up 0.5% from $12.4K in FY2023 and up 4.9% since FY2015, when it was $11.9K.

Figure 35 How Are Public Institutions Funded?



Share of core revenue per FTE student by source, public institutions, FY2024; dollars per FTE at right, 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Shares are of all five sources; the tuition share elsewhere in this profile divides net tuition by net tuition plus state and local appropriations only. Data from NCES, IPEDS Finance.

$15.5K
In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023
U.S. **$9.71K** · **7th** of 51

$8.67K
Appropriations per student, 2024
U.S. **$11.4K** · **42nd** of 51

59%
Tuition share of tuition plus appropriations, 2024
U.S. **43%** · **9th** of 51

74%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · **3rd** of 51

The table brings together five measures of what public higher education costs and what it produces in Rhode Island: in-state tuition at public four-year institutions, state and local appropriations per full-time-equivalent student, tuition's share of public institutions' core revenue, the six-year bachelor's graduation rate, and the average full-time faculty salary.

In-state tuition, public 4-year. The figure was $15.5K in 2023, against $9.71K for the U.S., 7th among the states, down 1.4% from $15.7K in 2022 and up 4.6% since 2015, when it was $14.8K.

Table 7 Money and Results

Measure	Year	Rhode Island	U.S.	Rank	Change since 2015
In-state tuition, public 4-year	2023	**$15.5K**	$9.71K	7th of 51	+4.6%
Appropriations per student	2024	**$8.67K**	$11.4K	42nd of 51	+28%
Tuition share of tuition plus appropriations	2024	**59%**	43%	9th of 51	−4.8 pp
Six-year graduation rate	2024	**74%**	65%	3rd of 51	+5.2 pp
Average faculty salary	2024	**$120K**	$106K	7th of 51	−5.2%

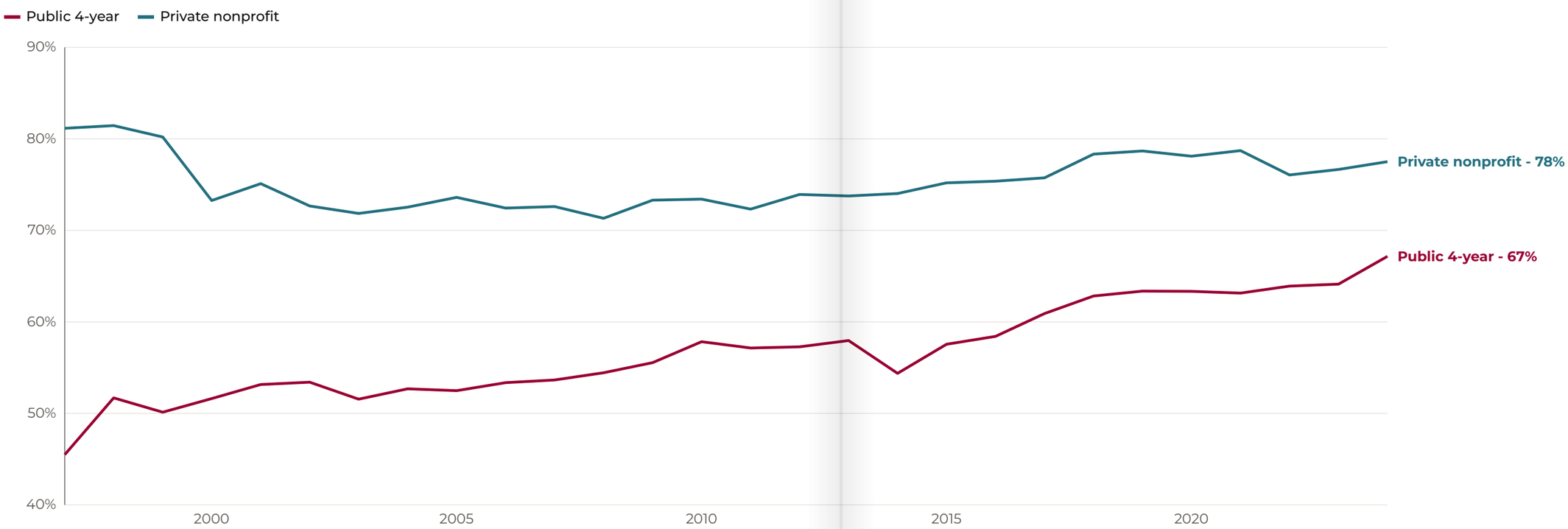
Rank among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). Dollars in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 14

Student Outcomes

Rhode Island ranks 3rd of 51 on the six-year bachelor's graduation rate, 4-year institutions, at 74% in 2024 against 65% for the U.S.

Figure 36 How Do Graduation Rates Differ by Sector?



Six-year bachelor's graduation rate by sector of institution. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

74% of students who started a bachelor's degree at a four-year institution in Rhode Island graduated within six years (2024), 9.0 points above the U.S. (65%); the state ranks 3rd of 51.

By sector: public 4-year 67%, private nonprofit 78%. At two-year institutions, 26% complete within 150% of normal time (U.S. 41%).

74%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · **3rd** of 51 · +5.2 pp since 2015

26%
Two-year completion rate, 2024
U.S. **41%** · **47th** of 50 · +12.3 pp since 2015

18.0
Bachelor's per 100 undergraduates, 2025
U.S. **12.3** · **4th** of 51 · +2.0 since 2015

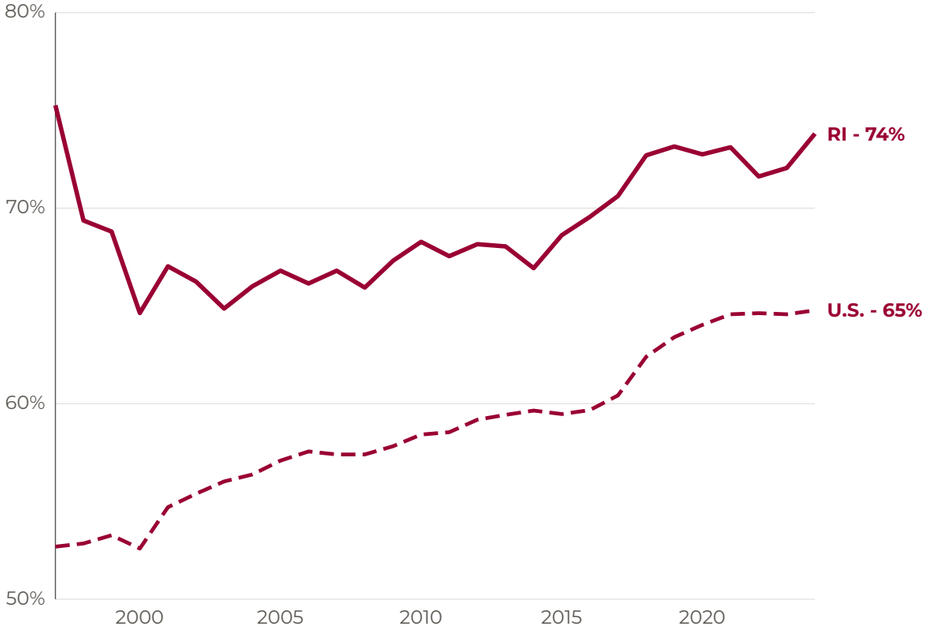
SECTION 14 · STUDENT OUTCOMES

How Many of Rhode Island's Students Graduate?

The line follows the share of first-time, full-time bachelor's-degree students at Rhode Island's four-year institutions who graduated from the institution where they started within six years (150% of normal time). Each year is the cohort that entered six years earlier. The rate leaves out students who start part-time (23% of the state's students attend part-time, against 39% nationally) and students who transfer and finish elsewhere. The state is solid and the United States dashed.

Six-year graduation rate. The rate was 74% in 2024, against 65% for the U.S., up 1.8 points from 72% in 2023 and up 5.2 points since 2015, when it was 69%.

Figure 37 Six-Year Bachelor's Graduation Rate



Four-year institutions; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

74%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · **3rd** of 51

26%
Two-year completion rate, 2024
U.S. **41%** · **47th** of 50

18.0
Bachelor's per 100 undergraduates, 2025
U.S. **12.3** · **4th** of 51

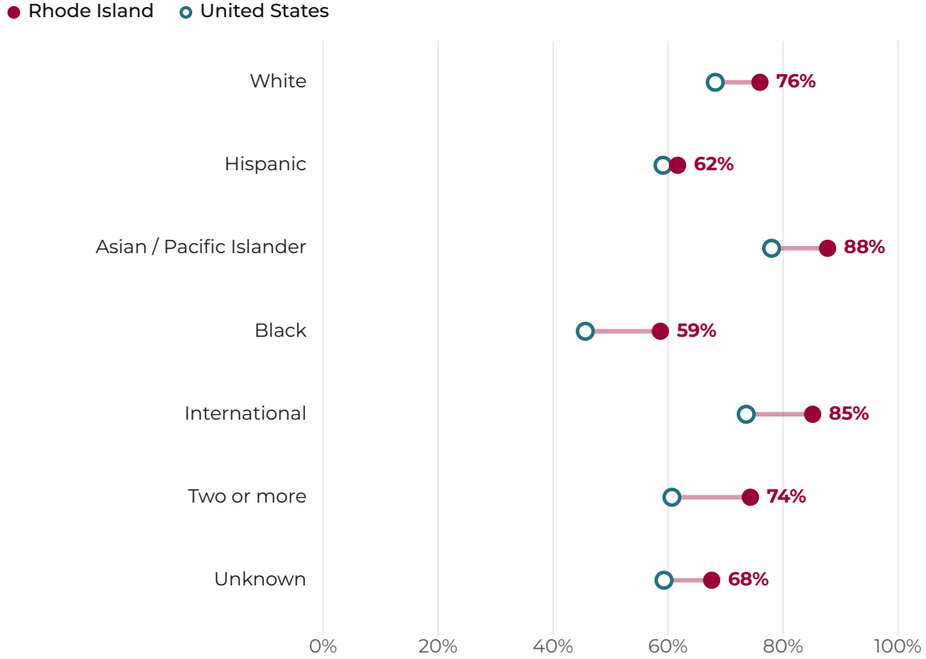
Each row is the six-year bachelor's graduation rate for one racial or ethnic group of students at Rhode Island's four-year institutions (filled dot), against the national rate for the same group (open dot). Groups with fewer than 100 students in the cohort are left out.

White. The six-year rate was 76% in 2024, against 68% for the U.S.

Hispanic. The six-year rate was 62% in 2024, against 59% for the U.S.

Asian / Pacific Islander. The six-year rate was 88% in 2024, against 78% for the U.S.

Figure 38 How Do Graduation Rates Differ by Race and Ethnicity?



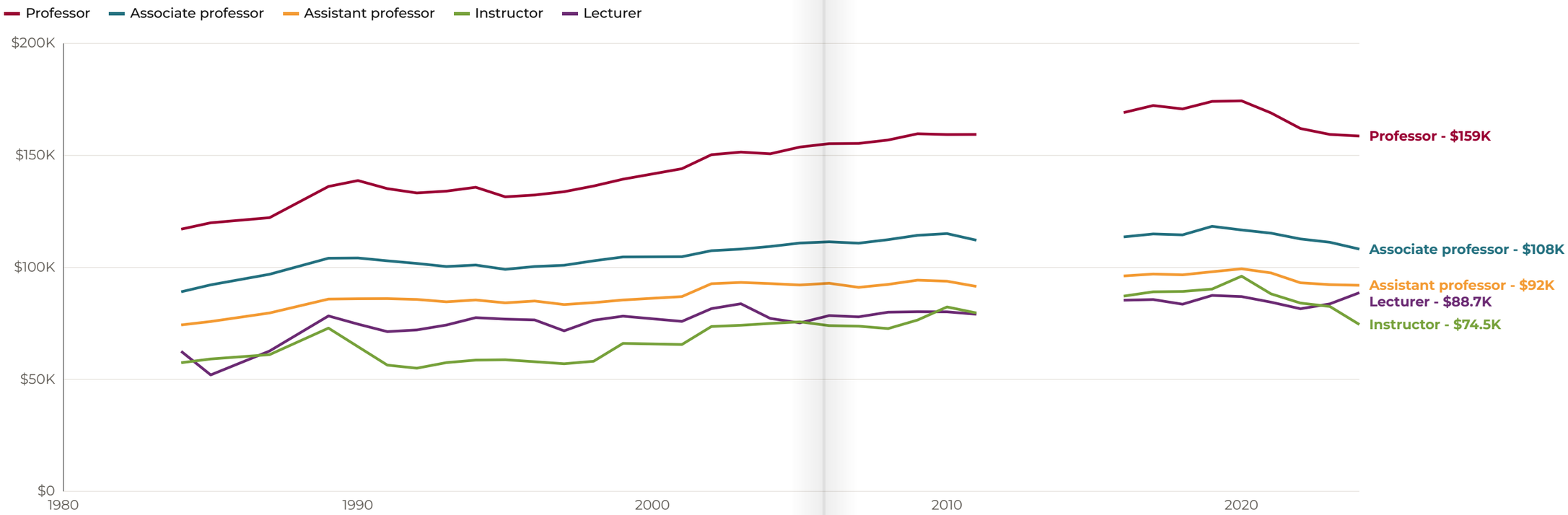
Six-year rate, 2024; groups with 100+ students. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 15

Faculty

Rhode Island ranks 7th of 51 on the average full-time faculty salary, at $120K in 2024 against $106K for the U.S.

Figure 39 What Do Rhode Island's Faculty Earn, by Rank?



Average salary of full-time instructional faculty on 9/10-month contracts, by academic rank, 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS Human Resources.

Full-time instructional faculty on 9/10-month contracts at Rhode Island's institutions earned an average of $120K in 2024 (2024 dollars), 14% above the U.S. ($106K); the state ranks 7th of 51. By rank (2024): professors $159K, associate professors $108K, assistant professors $92K, instructors $74.5K, lecturers $88.7K.

Rhode Island's institutions had 3.81K full-time instructional staff in 2024, up 7% since 2015. Average salary across all ranks is down 5% since 2016.

$120K

Average faculty salary, 2024

U.S. **$106K** · **7th** of 51 · −5.2% since 2016

SECTION 15 · FACULTY

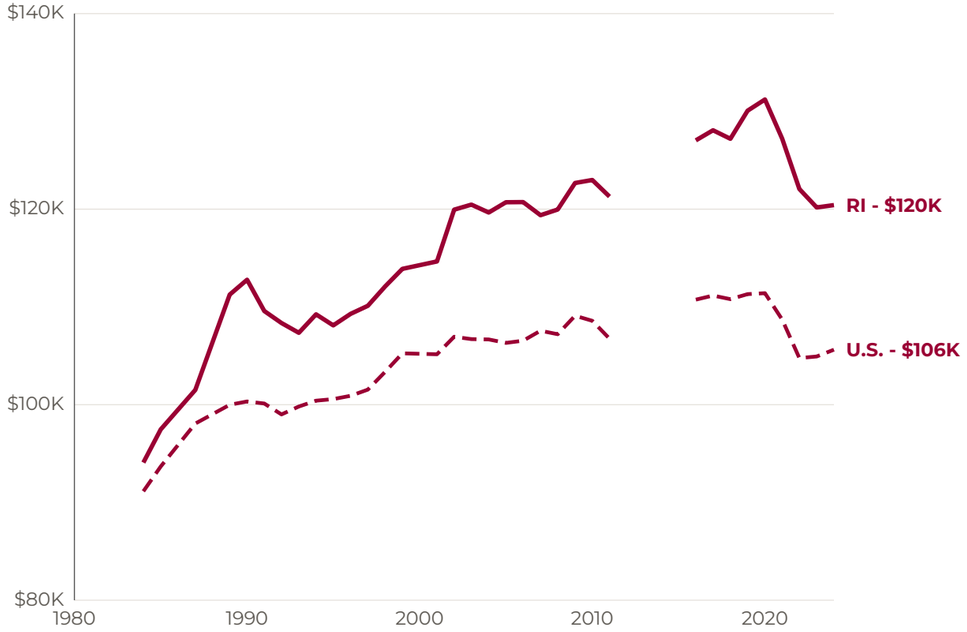
What Do Rhode Island's Faculty Earn, and How Many Hold Tenure?

The line follows the average salary of full-time instructional faculty on 9- or 10-month contracts at Rhode Island's degree-granting institutions, all ranks combined, in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). The state is solid and the United States dashed.

Average salary. The figure was $120K in 2024, against $106K for the U.S., 7th among the states, up 0.2% from $120K in 2023 and down 5.2% since 2016, when it was $127K.

Full-time instructional staff. The number was 3.81K in 2024, up 0.7% from 3.78K in 2023 and up 6.6% since 2015, when it was 3.57K.

Figure 40 Average Faculty Salary



Full-time instructional faculty, 9/10-month, 2024 dollars. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

$120K
Average faculty salary, 2024
U.S. **$106K** · **7th** of 51

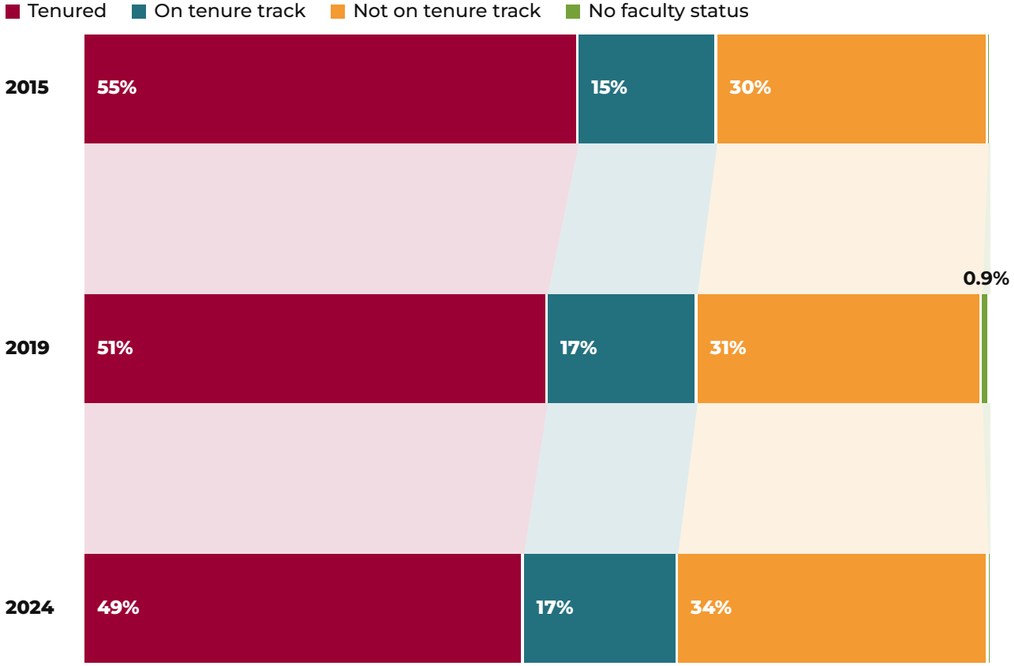
3.81K
Full-time instructional staff, 2024

49%
Tenured, 2024

The bars divide Rhode Island's full-time instructional staff by tenure status in 2015, 2019 and 2024: tenured, on the tenure track, not on the tenure track (for example, lecturers on fixed-term contracts), and staff at institutions with no tenure system.

Tenured, share of full-time instructional staff. The share was 49% in 2024, down 1.1 points from 50% in 2023 and down 6.1 points since 2015, when it was 55%.

Figure 41 Tenure Status



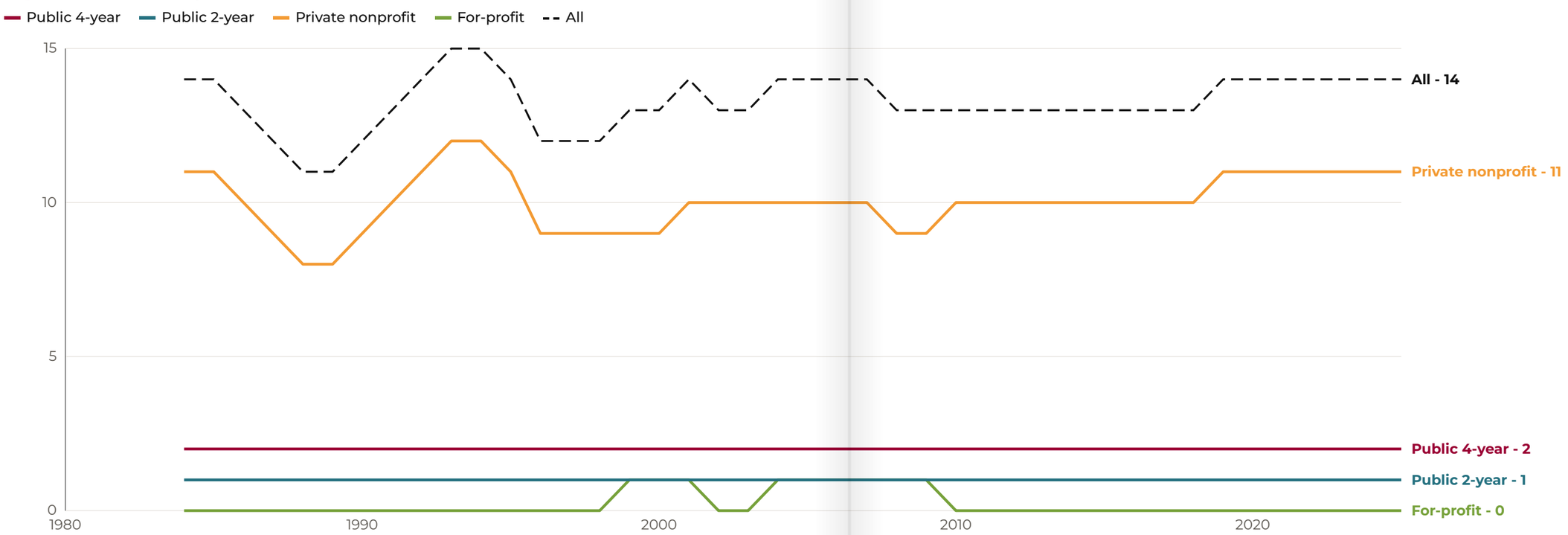
Full-time instructional staff by tenure status, 2015, 2019, 2024. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 16

Institutions

Rhode Island ranks 51st of 51 on the share of students enrolled exclusively online, at 11% in 2024 against 27% for the U.S.

Figure 42 How Many Institutions Does Rhode Island Have?



Degree-granting institutions by sector. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Rhode Island has 14 degree-granting institutions:2 public 4-year, 1 public 2-year, 11 private nonprofit, 0 for-profit (2025).

The number of institutions is up 8% since 2015. 47% of students attend public institutions and 0.0% attend for-profit ones.

47%

Students at public institutions, 2024

U.S. **73%** · **47th** of 51 · −3.1 pp since 2015

0.0%

Students at for-profit institutions, 2024

U.S. **5.5%** · **46th** of 51 · 0.0 pp since 2015

11%

Students fully online, 2024

U.S. **27%** · **51st** of 51 · +9.1 pp since 2015

SECTION 16 · INSTITUTIONS

Which Institutions Lead in Rhode Island?

The table ranks institutions in Rhode Island by the STEM master's degrees and research doctorates they awarded to international students in 2025, the two counted together. The share columns give international students' share of each institution's STEM degrees at that level.

Largest. Brown University (328 international STEM master's degrees and 58 doctorates), University of Rhode Island (28 international STEM master's degrees and 14 doctorates), and Rhode Island School of Design (42 international STEM master's degrees and – doctorates) awarded the most.

Table 8 Which Institutions Train the Most International STEM Graduates?

Institution	STEM total	STEM master's	Int. share	STEM doctorates	Int. share
Brown University Providence · Private nonprofit	**386**	328	58%	58	39%
University of Rhode Island Kingston · Public 4-year	**42**	28	17%	14	32%
Rhode Island School of Design Providence · Private nonprofit	**42**	42	70%	–	–
Johnson & Wales University-Providence Providence · Private nonprofit	**7**	7	64%	–	–
Roger Williams University Bristol · Private nonprofit	**1**	1	1.9%	–	–

Ranked by the total (shaded) of international STEM master's degrees and research doctorates. Degrees awarded in 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

14
Degree-granting institutions, 2025

47%
Students at public institutions, 2024
U.S. **73%** · **47th** of 51

0.0%
Students at for-profit institutions, 2024
U.S. **5.5%** · **46th** of 51

11%
Students fully online, 2024
U.S. **27%** · **51st** of 51

The table lists Rhode Island's largest degree-granting institutions by fall 2024 headcount enrollment, with the international share of graduate students, STEM bachelor's degrees awarded in 2025, the six-year graduation rate and the admission rate (a dash where the institution admits all applicants or does not report one).

Largest. The three largest were University of Rhode Island (17.2K students), Community College of Rhode Island (12.3K students), and Brown University (12K students).

Degree-granting institutions. The state had 14 in 2025, and 14 of them reported the enrollment and degree data in these tables.

Table 9 What Are Rhode Island's Largest Institutions?

Institution	Enrollment	Int. share, grad	STEM bachelor's	Six-year grad rate	Admit rate
University of Rhode Island	**17.2K**	11%	945	72%	72%
Community College of Rhode Island	**12.3K**	–	–	–	–
Brown University	**12K**	35%	939	96%	5.4%
Rhode Island College	**6.16K**	0.2%	73	48%	92%
Providence College	**4.67K**	4.2%	162	86%	51%
Roger Williams University	**4.35K**	0.6%	232	69%	88%
Johnson & Wales University-Providence	**4.3K**	15%	49	50%	88%
Bryant University	**3.64K**	12%	40	80%	65%
Johnson & Wales University-Online	**2.84K**	1.4%	20	–	91%
Salve Regina University	**2.79K**	1.5%	58	77%	68%

Fall 2024 enrollment; degrees 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

NOTES

About These Data

International students

U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas, as IPEDS defines them. IPEDS does not record country of citizenship. Permanent residents count with U.S. citizens.

STEM

CIP families 03, 04, 11, 14, 15, 26, 27 and 40. Doctorates are research and scholarship doctorates; professional doctorates appear only in the degree-count figure. Degrees are first majors only.

Universe

Degree-granting institutions located in the state; Title IV participants from 1996. Geography is the institution's location, not the student's home. Enrollment is fall headcount.

Migration

First-time degree-seeking undergraduates by home state, reported in even years before 2001 and every year since; odd years with incomplete reporting are omitted. Net migration is students arriving from other states minus residents leaving, per 100 resident first-time students.

Money

Tuition, appropriations, revenue and faculty salaries are in 2024 dollars using the CPI-U. Research funding (HERD, Federal Funds, USAspending), wages and the NAFSA economic contribution are nominal dollars, and are labeled so. Appropriations and revenue are per full-time-equivalent student at public institutions; the tuition share divides net tuition by net tuition plus state and local appropriations.

Race and ethnicity

IPEDS did not collect race and ethnicity in every year before 2010, and categories changed in 2008–2010; “Two or more” exists only from then.

Countries of citizenship

From DHS SEVIS by the Numbers: active F-1 and M-1 student records in the month named, at every level from primary school to doctorate, by the state of the school. IPEDS records only whether a student is a U.S. nonresident, not where they come from. SEVIS counts are monthly snapshots and are not directly comparable with IPEDS fall enrollment or degree counts. Year-to-year comparisons use one fall snapshot per year (the month closest to November).

Peers

Comparison states are the four closest in total fall enrollment, measured proportionally: a state 1.5 times as large counts as near as one two-thirds the size.

Sources

IPEDS (National Center for Education Statistics) is the backbone: Institutional Characteristics, Fall Enrollment, Completions, Graduation Rates, Finance, Human Resources and Admissions, 1980–2025, harmonized into a state panel. The profile also draws on NAEP, NSF's Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates, Survey of Earned Doctorates, HERD and Federal Funds surveys, USAspending.gov, DHS SEVIS by the Numbers and ICE SEVIS releases, the Department of Labor's Office of Foreign Labor Certification and BLS wage data, the USCIS H-1B Employer Data Hub, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes, USPTO PatentsView, and other federal sources; every figure names its source, and the Sources page lists them in full. Generated November 2026.

NOTES

How the Numbers Are Counted

Ranks

Ranks are among the 50 states and the District of Columbia (1 = highest value, whether or not a high value is good). Where fewer than 51 report, the count is given ("23rd of 33").

Sectors

Sectors are as IPEDS classifies institutions each year. IPEDS moves a whole institution to "public, 4-year or above" once it awards any bachelor's degree, so community colleges that began offering applied bachelor's degrees carry all of their students into the public 4-year sector. Sector series (enrollment shares, public 4-year tuition, graduation rates by sector) reflect these moves.

Research doctorates

Two counts appear. IPEDS counts degrees institutions report as "doctor's degree, research/scholarship", which includes some practice-oriented degrees such as many Ed.D.s; the NSF Survey of Earned Doctorates counts research doctorate recipients and is smaller. Each figure names which it uses. "STEM master's per STEM research doctorate" divides IPEDS STEM master's degrees by IPEDS STEM research doctorates.

Engineering

"Engineering" alone is CIP 14. Where engineering technology (CIP 15) is added, the label says "engineering & eng. technology".

Graduation rates

IPEDS graduation rates follow first-time, full-time students and count only those who finish at the institution where they started, so they leave out part-time starters and students who transfer and finish elsewhere.

International students in SEVIS

SEVIS counts active F-1 and M-1 records, which include graduates on Optional Practical Training (up to 36 months for STEM graduates, 12 for others), so STEM shares run high. STEM follows the DHS STEM Designated Degree Program List, which is broader than the eight CIP families above, and DHS draws its STEM pages on a different basis from its all-student pages, so a country's STEM count can exceed its all-level count.

Visas and green cards

DOL labor condition applications (H-1B positions) are counted by worksite and include renewals and job changes; USCIS approvals are counted by the employer's address and split into new and continuing. PERM certifications are the employer's step toward a green card.

Patents

Patents are counted by the owner's (assignee's) location, not where inventors live; a company headquartered in another state takes its patents there.

Years

Each measure uses its latest year, so years differ across a page; every figure, table and statement gives its year, and lines that stop early are labeled with their last year.

Rhode Island – By the Numbers

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
K-12 PREPARATION							
Grade 8 mathematics, average score	281	**270**[2024]	−11.6 ▼	272	−9.0 ▼	#32	[5]
Grade 8 mathematics: at or above Proficient	32%	**26%**[2024]	−5.9 pp ▼	27%	−5.3 pp ▼	#27	[5]
Grade 4 mathematics, average score	238	**237**[2024]	−0.7 ▼	237	−2.5 ▼	#28	[5]
Grade 4 mathematics: at or above Proficient	37%	**38%**[2024]	+0.9 pp ▲	39%	0.0 pp	#29	[5]
Grade 8 reading, average score	265	**258**[2024]	−7.3 ▼	257	−7.3 ▼	#23	[5]
Grade 8 reading: at or above Proficient	35%	**30%**[2024]	−4.4 pp ▼	29%	−4.0 pp ▼	#20	[5]
Grade 4 reading, average score	225	**216**[2024]	−9.2 ▼	214	−7.1 ▼	#13	[5]
Grade 8 science, average score, 2009 framework	–	**151**[2015]	–	153	–	#33	[5]
Current spending per public-school pupil	$20.7K	**$22.1K**[2021]	+7.1% ▲	$16.8K	+12% ▲	#9	[3]
Public high school 4-year graduation rate, ACGR	83%	**83%**[2022]	0.0 pp	87%	+4.0 pp ▲	#37	[3]
Public high school graduates	9.6K	**9.48K**[2024]	−1.2% ▼	3.49M	+8.8% ▲	#45	[3]
Average public-school teacher salary	$86.2K	**$84.4K**[2022]	−2.2% ▼	$72.9K	−3.0% ▼	#8	[3]
Pupils per teacher, public schools	13.4	**12.7**[2022]	−0.7 ▼	15.4	−0.6 ▼	#40	[3]
Public elementary and secondary enrollment	142K	**136K**[2024]	−4.3% ▼	49.4M	−2.1% ▼	#46	[3]
Public-school students eligible for free or reduced-price lunch	47%	**46%**[2023]	−0.7 pp ▼	53%	+1.5 pp ▲	#30	[3]
English learners as a share of public-school students	7.1%	**13%**[2022]	+5.4 pp ▲	11%	+1.0 pp ▲	#6	[3]
Charter-school share of public-school enrollment	4.6%	**8.9%**[2023]	+4.3 pp ▲	7.6%	+2.2 pp ▲	#15	[3]
High schools offering calculus	76%[2016]	**73%**[2024]	−3.2 pp ▼	51%	−5.8 pp ▼	#4	[14]
High schools offering physics	76%[2016]	**87%**[2024]	+11.3 pp ▲	64%	−2.4 pp ▼	#4	[14]
High schools offering chemistry	85%[2016]	**92%**[2024]	+6.5 pp ▲	81%	+0.7 pp ▲	#10	[14]
High schools offering Algebra II	95%[2016]	**98%**[2024]	+3.2 pp ▲	87%	+1.3 pp ▲	#2	[14]
High schools offering computer science	86%[2021]	**87%**[2024]	+1.4 pp ▲	55%	+2.0 pp ▲	#3	[14]
High schools offering any AP course	74%[2016]	**81%**[2024]	+6.5 pp ▲	56%	0.0 pp	#5	[14]
High schools offering AP computer science	51%[2021]	**60%**[2024]	+8.8 pp ▲	25%	+2.6 pp ▲	#2	[14]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

RHODE ISLAND – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
K-12 PREPARATION (CONTINUED)							
High schools offering dual enrollment	53%[2016]	**85%[2024]**	+32.3 pp ▲	71%	+11.1 pp ▲	#8	[14]
AP course enrollments per 100 high-school students	13.7[2016]	**23.5[2024]**	+9.8 ▲	18.4	+1.0 ▲	#4	[14]
Calculus enrollments per 100 high-school students	4.7[2016]	**4.1[2024]**	−0.6 ▼	3.3	−1.0 ▼	#9	[14]
Physics enrollments per 100 high-school students	9.9[2016]	**17.3[2024]**	+7.3 ▲	9.4	−0.4 ▼	#4	[14]
SAT or ACT takers per 100 high-school students	12.3[2016]	**23.1[2024]**	+10.9 ▲	18.1	−2.5 ▼	#14	[14]
Students in gifted and talented programs per 100 students	0.1[2016]	**0.1[2024]**	0.0	7.0	+0.4 ▲	#49	[14]
ENROLLMENT AND INSTITUTIONS							
Pell Grant share of undergraduates	34%	**34%[2025]**	+0.1 pp ▲	36%	−0.8 pp ▼	#25	[15]
Fall enrollment	82.3K	**75.6K[2024]**	−8.1% ▼	19.7M	−1.7% ▼	#43	[4]
Share of enrollment at public institutions	50%	**47%[2024]**	−3.1 pp ▼	73%	0.0 pp	#47	[4]
Share of enrollment at for-profit institutions	0.0%	**0.0%[2024]**	0.0 pp	5.5%	−1.2 pp ▼	#46	[4]
Share of students enrolled part-time	25%	**23%[2024]**	−2.3 pp ▼	39%	+0.7 pp ▲	#51	[4]
Share of students who are graduate students	13%	**16%[2024]**	+3.0 pp ▲	17%	+2.0 pp ▲	#25	[4]
Share of students enrolled exclusively online	2.1%	**11%[2024]**	+9.1 pp ▲	27%	+12.1 pp ▲	#51	[4]
DEGREES AND FIELDS OF STUDY							
Research doctorates awarded	320	**354[2025]**	+11% ▲	59K	+7.3% ▲	#36	[7]
Science & engineering research doctorates, excluding health	227	**273[2025]**	+20% ▲	44.4K	+14% ▲	#36	[7]
Share of U.S. research doctorates	0.6%	**0.6%[2025]**	0.0 pp	–	–	#36	[7]
Engineering research doctorates	35	**50[2025]**	–	10.9K	+9.9% ▲	#36	[7]
Mathematics & computer science research doctorates	36	**38[2025]**	–	5.07K	+33% ▲	#29	[7]
STEM master's degrees per research doctorate	2.7	**4.5[2025]**	+1.8 ▲	6.4	+2.1 ▲	#35	[4]
STEM share of bachelor's	17%	**23%[2025]**	+5.7 pp ▲	24%	+5.3 pp ▲	#25	[4]
Share of bachelor's in computer & information sciences	3.0%	**5.7%[2025]**	+2.7 pp ▲	6.9%	+3.7 pp ▲	#26	[4]
Share of bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology	4.1%	**4.1%[2025]**	0.0 pp	6.8%	+0.7 pp ▲	#45	[4]
Share of bachelor's in mathematics & statistics	1.6%	**2.5%[2025]**	+0.9 pp ▲	1.2%	0.0 pp	#1	[4]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). “pp” is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

RHODE ISLAND – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
DEGREES AND FIELDS OF STUDY (CONTINUED)							
Share of bachelor's in biological & biomedical sciences	5.4%	**7.1%**[2025]	+1.8 pp ▲	6.6%	+0.8 pp ▲	#19	[4]
Share of bachelor's in physical sciences	0.9%	**0.8%**[2025]	−0.1 pp ▼	1.3%	−0.3 pp ▼	#46	[4]
Share of bachelor's in health professions	7.7%	**8.1%**[2025]	+0.4 pp ▲	12%	+1.1 pp ▲	#48	[4]
Share of bachelor's in business	23%	**20%**[2025]	−2.3 pp ▼	19%	−0.1 pp ▼	#19	[4]
STEM share of master's	18%	**23%**[2025]	+5.6 pp ▲	23%	+6.7 pp ▲	#19	[4]
Share of master's in computer & information sciences	2.6%	**6.7%**[2025]	+4.1 pp ▲	10%	+6.3 pp ▲	#31	[4]
Share of master's in engineering & eng. technology	4.9%	**6.5%**[2025]	+1.6 pp ▲	6.7%	−0.2 pp ▼	#21	[4]
Share of master's in mathematics & statistics	1.1%	**1.3%**[2025]	+0.2 pp ▲	1.3%	+0.3 pp ▲	#16	[4]
Share of master's in biological & biomedical sciences	2.3%	**2.4%**[2025]	+0.1 pp ▲	2.5%	+0.6 pp ▲	#25	[4]
Share of master's in physical sciences	1.6%	**3.1%**[2025]	+1.5 pp ▲	0.8%	−0.1 pp ▼	#2	[4]
Share of master's in health professions	7.7%	**15%**[2025]	+7.5 pp ▲	15%	+1.7 pp ▲	#22	[4]
Share of master's in business	33%	**21%**[2025]	−12.9 pp ▼	21%	−3.2 pp ▼	#26	[4]
STEM share of research doctorates	51%	**42%**[2025]	−9.2 pp ▼	39%	−2.2 pp ▼	#29	[4]
Share of research doctorates in computer & information sciences	3.3%	**4.4%**[2025]	+1.1 pp ▲	4.2%	+1.4 pp ▲	#16	[4]
Share of research doctorates in engineering & eng. technology	11%	**11%**[2025]	+0.4 pp ▲	14%	−1.0 pp ▼	#32	[4]
Share of research doctorates in mathematics & statistics	6.5%	**3.7%**[2025]	−2.8 pp ▼	2.4%	−0.2 pp ▼	#4	[4]
Share of research doctorates in biological & biomedical sciences	12%	**10%**[2025]	−1.9 pp ▼	10%	−1.1 pp ▼	#30	[4]
Share of research doctorates in physical sciences	18%	**12%**[2025]	−5.3 pp ▼	7.1%	−1.1 pp ▼	#8	[4]
Share of research doctorates in health professions	4.2%	**12%**[2025]	+8.3 pp ▲	12%	+3.5 pp ▲	#17	[4]
Share of research doctorates in business	0.6%	**8.5%**[2025]	+7.9 pp ▲	5.6%	+1.3 pp ▲	#12	[4]
Bachelor's degrees per 100 undergraduates	16.0	**18.0**[2025]	+2.0 ▲	12.3	+1.4 ▲	#4	[4]
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS							
First-time students from outside the U.S.	4.0%[2016]	**4.5%**[2024]	+0.5 pp ▲	3.1%	+0.1 pp ▲	#8	[4]
STEM master's degrees earned by international students	176	**406**[2025]	2.31× ▲	117K	2.18× ▲	#36	[4]
Share of all U.S. international STEM master's degrees	0.3%	**0.3%**[2025]	0.0 pp	–	–	#36	[4]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

RHODE ISLAND – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS (CONTINUED)							
International share of undergraduate enrollment	4.5%	**5.7%**[2024]	+1.2 pp ▲	3.0%	−0.3 pp ▼	#3	[4]
International share of graduate enrollment	17%	**18%**[2024]	+0.4 pp ▲	17%	+2.8 pp ▲	#15	[4]
International share of all bachelor's	5.3%	**4.5%**[2025]	−0.8 pp ▼	4.1%	+0.1 pp ▲	#12	[4]
International share of STEM bachelor's	7.6%	**6.6%**[2025]	−1.0 pp ▼	6.6%	+0.8 pp ▲	#16	[4]
International share of all master's	24%	**21%**[2025]	−3.8 pp ▼	22%	+6.2 pp ▲	#17	[4]
International share of STEM master's	38%	**47%**[2025]	+8.9 pp ▲	52%	+9.1 pp ▲	#24	[4]
International share of computer & information sciences master's	42%	**52%**[2025]	+9.8 pp ▲	65%	+10.1 pp ▲	#30	[4]
International share of engineering & eng. technology master's	47%	**61%**[2025]	+14.0 pp ▲	50%	+0.9 pp ▲	#7	[4]
International share of mathematics & statistics master's	30%[2019]	**29%**[2025]	−1.2 pp ▼	55%	−3.5 pp ▼	#28	[4]
International share of biological & biomedical sciences master's	23%	**34%**[2025]	+10.8 pp ▲	23%	+6.2 pp ▲	#6	[4]
International share of physical sciences master's	32%	**47%**[2025]	+15.6 pp ▲	33%	+3.6 pp ▲	#3	[4]
International share of all research doctorates	28%	**25%**[2025]	−2.8 pp ▼	25%	−1.0 pp ▼	#28	[4]
International share of STEM research doctorates	37%	**38%**[2025]	+0.9 pp ▲	43%	−0.5 pp ▼	#34	[4]
International share of engineering & eng. technology research doctorates	47%	**45%**[2025]	−2.1 pp ▼	55%	−1.0 pp ▼	#37	[4]
International share of biological & biomedical sciences research doctorates	17%	**19%**[2025]	+2.1 pp ▲	23%	−4.3 pp ▼	#30	[4]
International share of physical sciences research doctorates	41%	**36%**[2025]	−5.0 pp ▼	38%	−1.1 pp ▼	#23	[4]
Active F-1/M-1 students, all levels	6.09K	**5.06K**[2026]	−17% ▼	1.19M	−0.1% ▼	#37	[20]
Share of U.S. active F-1/M-1 students	0.5%	**0.4%**[2026]	−0.1 pp ▼	–	–	#37	[20]
Share of F-1/M-1 students from India	7.3%	**11%**[2026]	+3.2 pp ▲	27%	+11.4 pp ▲	#38	[20]
Share of F-1/M-1 students from China	35%	**30%**[2026]	−5.0 pp ▼	18%	−11.7 pp ▼	#3	[20]
Share from the two largest countries of origin	45%	**41%**[2026]	−3.7 pp ▼	45%	−0.3 pp ▼	#22	[20]
Countries of citizenship represented	148	**139**[2026]	−6.1% ▼	219	−2.7% ▼	#41	[20]
Active STEM F-1/M-1 students	1.53K	**2.73K**[2026]	+78% ▲	749K	+61% ▲	#36	[20]
Active STEM master's students	361	**1.14K**[2026]	3.17× ▲	393K	+90% ▲	#37	[20]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

RHODE ISLAND – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS (CONTINUED)							
Active STEM doctoral students	526	**708**[2026]	+35% ▲	158K	+61% ▲	#38	[20]
Share of STEM master's students from India	17%	**31%**[2026]	+13.8 pp ▲	58%	−1.8 pp ▼	#46	[20]
U.S. students studying abroad for credit, from the state's institutions	3.19K[2017]	**2.52K**[2024]	−21% ▼	–	–	#34	[1]
Economic contribution of international students, nominal dollars	$264M[2018]	**$272M**[2024]	+3.3% ▲	$42.9B	+4.6% ▲	#28	[2]
Jobs supported by international students' spending	2.65K[2018]	**2.22K**[2024]	−16% ▼	356K	−22% ▼	#27	[2]
Share of U.S. student and exchange-visitor admissions, by destination	0.4%	**0.4%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#35	[16]
Share of U.S. F-1 student admissions, by destination	0.4%	**0.4%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#31	[16]
Share of U.S. J-1 exchange-visitor admissions, by destination	0.4%	**0.4%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#38	[16]
J-1 exchange visitors starting a program in the state	1.67K	**1.56K**[2025]	−6.4% ▼	275K	−14% ▼	#39	[18]
GRADUATE EDUCATION AND RESEARCH							
Graduate students in science & engineering	2.44K	**2.42K**[2016]	−0.8% ▼	620K	+0.4% ▲	#38	[9]
S&E graduate students on temporary visas	835	**834**[2016]	−0.1% ▼	241K	+2.3% ▲	#39	[9]
Temporary-visa share of S&E graduate students	34%	**34%**[2016]	+0.2 pp ▲	39%	+0.7 pp ▲	#23	[9]
Temporary-visa share of engineering graduate students	47%	**42%**[2016]	−4.8 pp ▼	57%	0.0 pp	#40	[9]
S&E postdoctoral appointees	273	**327**[2016]	+20% ▲	45.7K	+1.0% ▲	#27	[9]
Temporary-visa share of S&E postdocs	46%	**48%**[2016]	+2.5 pp ▲	56%	−0.9 pp ▼	#35	[9]
University R&D spending, nominal dollars	$453M	**$533M**[2024]	+18% ▲	$118B	+71% ▲	#38	[6]
Share of U.S. university R&D	0.7%	**0.5%**[2024]	−0.2 pp ▼	–	–	#38	[6]
Federally funded share of university R&D	46%	**71%**[2024]	+24.8 pp ▲	55%	−0.2 pp ▼	#3	[6]
Business-funded share of university R&D	1.4%	**2.0%**[2024]	+0.7 pp ▲	5.4%	−0.4 pp ▼	#43	[6]
State- and locally funded share of university R&D	2.3%	**0.7%**[2024]	−1.6 pp ▼	5.2%	−0.4 pp ▼	#48	[6]
University R&D in mathematics and computer science, nominal dollars	$39.9M	**$37.8M**[2024]	−5.1% ▼	$5.12B	+97% ▲	#25	[6]
University R&D in engineering, nominal dollars	$42.4M	**$52M**[2024]	+23% ▲	$19.3B	+74% ▲	#45	[6]
University R&D personnel, headcount	5.68K	**3.03K**[2024]	−47% ▼	1.09M	+20% ▲	#47	[6]
Federal R&D obligations to the state, nominal dollars	$519M	**$930M**[2024]	+79% ▲	$193B	+53% ▲	#29	[8]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

RHODE ISLAND – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
GRADUATE EDUCATION AND RESEARCH (CONTINUED)							
Federal R&D obligations to universities in the state, nominal dollars	$149M	**$274M**[2024]	+83% ▲	$44.4B	+64% ▲	#32	[8]
Defense R&D obligations to the state, nominal dollars	$303M	**$566M**[2024]	+87% ▲	$97.2B	+60% ▲	#26	[8]
Health (HHS/NIH) R&D obligations to the state, nominal dollars	$134M	**$240M**[2024]	+79% ▲	$48.5B	+62% ▲	#29	[8]
NSF, NIH, NASA and DOE Science grants performed in the state, nominal dollars	$188M	**$329M**[2025]	+74% ▲	$45B	+47% ▲	#28	[19]
Federal R&D contracts performed in the state, nominal dollars	$39M	**$362M**[2026]	+322.8 ▲	$59.3B	+22,105.9 ▲	#22	[19]
COLLEGE COSTS AND OUTCOMES							
Median earnings 10 years after entering college	$45.7K[2020]	**$53.9K**[2022]	+18% ▲	$47.5K	+11% ▲	#9	[15]
Median earnings 1 year after completing	–	**$52.7K**[2025]	–	$47.5K	–	#8	[15]
Median debt of completers, nominal dollars	$23.3K	**$20.5K**[2024]	−12% ▼	$17.6K	−4.6% ▼	#10	[15]
STEM bachelor's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$59.3K**[2025]	–	$68.2K	–	#48	[15]
Non-STEM bachelor's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$47.5K**[2025]	–	$51.9K	–	#39	[15]
Bachelor's graduates: median earnings 5 years out	–	**$62.8K**[2025]	–	$68.1K	–	#42	[15]
STEM master's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$62.4K**[2025]	–	$91.6K	–	#45	[15]
Six-year bachelor's graduation rate, 4-year institutions	69%	**74%**[2024]	+5.2 pp ▲	65%	+5.3 pp ▲	#3	[4]
Completion within 150% of normal time, 2-year institutions	14%	**26%**[2024]	+12.3 pp ▲	41%	+12.1 pp ▲	#47	[4]
In-state tuition & fees, public 4-year	$14.8K	**$15.5K**[2023]	+4.6% ▲	$9.71K	−14% ▼	#7	[4]
State & local appropriations per FTE, public institutions	$6.75K	**$8.67K**[2024]	+28% ▲	$11.4K	+22% ▲	#42	[4]
Net tuition share of tuition plus state and local appropriations, public institutions	64%	**59%**[2024]	−4.8 pp ▼	43%	−5.9 pp ▼	#9	[4]
Average full-time faculty salary (9/10-month)	$127K[2016]	**$120K**[2024]	−5.2% ▼	$106K	−4.6% ▼	#7	[4]
WHERE STUDENTS AND GRADUATES GO							
International graduates on OPT working in the state where they studied	21%	**23%**[2016]	+2.2 pp ▲	44%	−1.8 pp ▼	#44	[21]
OPT retention, bachelor's graduates	20%	**18%**[2016]	−2.0 pp ▼	58%	+0.3 pp ▲	#51	[21]
OPT retention, master's graduates	17%	**30%**[2016]	+12.4 pp ▲	39%	−2.5 pp ▼	#29	[21]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). “pp” is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

RHODE ISLAND – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WHERE STUDENTS AND GRADUATES GO (CONTINUED)							
OPT retention, STEM graduates	18%	**22%**[2016]	+3.1 pp ▲	37%	−1.9 pp ▼	#37	[21]
OPT workers employed in the state per OPT graduate of its schools	0.39	**0.46**[2016]	+0.1 ▲	1.00	0.0	#45	[21]
STEM OPT extensions approved, by state of the school	85	**122**[2016]	+44% ▲	41.2K	+51% ▲	#39	[21]
Bachelor's graduates working in the state 1 year after graduating (PSEO)	13%[2016]	**14%**[2019]	+0.5 pp ▲	72%	−0.1 pp ▼	#33	[11]
Bachelor's graduates working in the state 5 years after graduating (PSEO)	–	**12%**[2016]	–	65%	–	#36	[11]
Bachelor's graduates working in the state 10 years after graduating (PSEO)	–	**12%**[2010]	–	64%	–	#33	[11]
STEM bachelor's graduates working in the state 1 year out (PSEO)	15%[2016]	**16%**[2019]	+1.0 pp ▲	67%	+1.5 pp ▲	#33	[11]
Master's graduates working in the state 1 year out (PSEO)	–	**43%**[2016]	–	66%	–	#35	[11]
Bachelor's graduates' median earnings 1 year out (PSEO)	$58.1K[2016]	**$59.4K**[2019]	+2.2% ▲	$48.1K	+2.3% ▲	#1	[11]
Bachelor's graduates' median earnings 5 years out (PSEO)	–	**$89.9K**[2016]	–	$67.3K	–	#1	[11]
STEM bachelor's graduates' median earnings 1 year out (PSEO)	$57K[2016]	**$55.2K**[2019]	−3.1% ▼	$59.3K	+0.1% ▲	#24	[11]
Net domestic migration of bachelor's-plus adults, per 1,000 residents	+1.7	**+0.7**[2025]	−1.0 ▼	–	–	#27	[12]
Net domestic migration of graduate-degree holders	−203	**−351**[2025]	−148.0 ▼	–	–	#33	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who moved in from another state	4.9%	**4.0%**[2025]	−0.9 pp ▼	–	–	#9	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who moved out to another state	4.7%	**3.9%**[2025]	−0.8 pp ▼	–	–	#4	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who arrived from abroad in the past year	1.6K	**2.08K**[2025]	+30% ▲	–	–	#40	[12]
First-time students who are in-state residents	37%[2016]	**41%**[2024]	+4.0 pp ▲	–	–	#48	[4]
Net student migration (per 100 resident first-time students)	+69[2016]	**+58**[2024]	−11.8 ▼	–	–	#3	[4]
Recent high school graduates who go to college out of state	37%[2016]	**34%**[2022]	−3.6 pp ▼	22%	+2.5 pp ▲	#14	[3]
WORK VISAS AND GREEN CARDS							
Certified H-1B positions, by worksite	4.63K	**2.06K**[2025]	−56% ▼	914K	−24% ▼	#37	[17]
Share of U.S. certified H-1B positions	0.4%	**0.2%**[2025]	−0.2 pp ▼	–	–	#37	[17]
STEM share of certified H-1B positions	90%	**67%**[2025]	−22.8 pp ▼	76%	−7.8 pp ▼	#25	[17]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

RHODE ISLAND – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WORK VISAS AND GREEN CARDS (CONTINUED)							
Median offered H-1B wage, nominal dollars, nominal dollars	$71.2K	**$110K**[2025]	+55% ▲	$119K	+66% ▲	#14	[17]
H-1B positions at H-1B-dependent employers	69%	**26%**[2025]	−42.9 pp ▼	22%	−25.7 pp ▼	#13	[17]
Green-card labor certifications	128	**202**[2025]	+58% ▲	138K	+75% ▲	#43	[17]
Share of PERM certifications for citizens of India	67%	**64%**[2024]	−2.9 pp ▼	47%	−10.6 pp ▼	#3	[17]
PERM certifications for workers on F-1 student visas	4.7%	**2.6%**[2024]	−2.1 pp ▼	8.7%	+4.9 pp ▲	#49	[17]
PERM workers with a master's or doctorate	53%	**47%**[2024]	−6.1 pp ▼	47%	−4.9 pp ▼	#15	[17]
STEM share of PERM certifications	68%	**61%**[2025]	−6.1 pp ▼	49%	−25.8 pp ▼	#7	[17]
Median offered PERM wage, nominal dollars, nominal dollars	$96.9K	**$120K**[2025]	+24% ▲	$100K	+9.9% ▲	#5	[17]
New lawful permanent residents (green cards), by state of residence	3.61K	**4.41K**[2024]	+22% ▲	1.36M	+30% ▲	#37	[16]
Share of U.S. new green-card holders	0.3%	**0.3%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#37	[16]
People naturalized as U.S. citizens, by state of residence	2.73K	**3.31K**[2024]	+21% ▲	819K	+12% ▲	#33	[16]
Share of U.S. naturalizations	0.4%	**0.4%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#33	[16]
Share of U.S. temporary-worker admissions, by destination	0.1%	**0.1%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#49	[16]
Share of U.S. H-1B worker admissions, by destination	0.3%	**0.2%**[2024]	−0.1 pp ▼	–	–	#38	[16]
Share of U.S. L-1 intracompany-transferee admissions, by destination	0.1%	**0.1%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#46	[16]
Share of U.S. O-1 extraordinary-ability worker admissions, by destination	0.1%	**0.2%**[2024]	+0.1 pp ▲	–	–	#31	[16]
New H-1B approvals (initial), by employer state	161	**436**[2026]	2.71× ▲	127K	+14% ▲	#33	[13]
Continuing H-1B approvals, by employer state	416	**1.65K**[2026]	3.97× ▲	268K	+52% ▲	#25	[13]
Share of U.S. new H-1B approvals	0.1%	**0.3%**[2026]	+0.2 pp ▲	–	–	#33	[13]
Denial rate, new H-1B petitions	6.4%	**1.8%**[2026]	−4.6 pp ▼	3.4%	−3.0 pp ▼	#50	[13]
New H-1B approvals at colleges and schools (NAICS 61)	20%	**11%**[2026]	−9.7 pp ▼	8.6%	−1.7 pp ▼	#36	[13]
New H-1B approvals in professional, scientific & technical services	27%	**7.8%**[2026]	−19.5 pp ▼	44%	−12.5 pp ▼	#48	[13]
Five largest employers' share of new H-1B approvals	40%	**58%**[2026]	+17.2 pp ▲	9.1%	−6.7 pp ▼	#8	[13]
STEM WORKFORCE AND INNOVATION							

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

RHODE ISLAND – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
STEM WORKFORCE AND INNOVATION (CONTINUED)							
Workers in STEM occupations	28.7K	**48.4K**[2024]	+69% ▲	13.7M	+51% ▲	#41	[12]
STEM workers as a share of all workers	5.4%	**8.3%**[2024]	+2.9 pp ▲	8.1%	+2.1 pp ▲	#14	[12]
Foreign-born share of STEM workers	16%	**15%**[2024]	−0.3 pp ▼	24%	+1.6 pp ▲	#22	[12]
Foreign-born share of STEM workers with a graduate degree	24%[2017]	**22%**[2024]	−2.3 pp ▼	41%	+1.3 pp ▲	#35	[12]
Noncitizen share of STEM workers	9.5%	**7.1%**[2024]	−2.5 pp ▼	11%	+0.7 pp ▲	#24	[12]
STEM workers born abroad who arrived in the last 10 years	6.0%	**3.7%**[2024]	−2.3 pp ▼	7.5%	+0.3 pp ▲	#37	[12]
Foreign-born share of residents	13%	**15%**[2025]	+1.4 pp ▲	15%	+1.3 pp ▲	#13	[12]
Foreign-born share of graduate-degree holders, 25+	13%	**15%**[2025]	+1.4 pp ▲	21%	+2.8 pp ▲	#21	[12]
STEM jobs, employer survey	25.9K	**31.7K**[2025]	+22% ▲	10.4M	+26% ▲	#44	[10]
STEM jobs concentration vs the U.S., location quotient	0.92	**0.95**[2025]	0.0	1.00	0.0	#19	[10]
Mean annual STEM wage, nominal, nominal dollars	$85.3K	**$114K**[2025]	+34% ▲	$120K	+38% ▲	#17	[10]
Median software developer wage, nominal, nominal dollars	$101K[2019]	**$131K**[2025]	+29% ▲	$136K	+26% ▲	#20	[10]
Software developer jobs	3.04K	**5.07K**[2025]	+67% ▲	1.69M	+48% ▲	#37	[10]
Mean annual wage, all occupations, nominal, nominal dollars	$50.8K	**$71.9K**[2025]	+42% ▲	$69.8K	+44% ▲	#13	[10]
Patents granted to assignees in the state	268	**410**[2025]	+53% ▲	135K	−0.6% ▼	#34	[22]
Share of U.S.-assignee patents	0.2%	**0.3%**[2025]	+0.1 pp ▲	–	–	#34	[22]
Share of the state's patents in digital technologies	11%	**9.3%**[2025]	−2.1 pp ▼	43%	+1.6 pp ▲	#44	[22]
Share of the state's patents in life sciences	14%	**14%**[2025]	−0.2 pp ▼	17%	+0.4 pp ▲	#32	[22]
Share of the state's patents in semiconductors	0.7%	**0.7%**[2025]	0.0 pp	2.9%	−1.7 pp ▼	#24	[22]
Women's share of inventors on the state's patents	6.9%	**11%**[2025]	+4.1 pp ▲	14%	+3.4 pp ▲	#33	[22]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). “pp” is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

Sources

[1] Institute of International Education. *Open Doors Report on International Educational Exchange: State Fact Sheets*. Editions 2020–2026. New York: Institute of International Education. https://opendoorsdata.org/. Accessed November 2026.

[2] NAFSA: Association of International Educators. *NAFSA International Student Economic Value Tool*. Academic years 2018–19 to 2024–25. Washington, DC: NAFSA. https://www.nafsa.org/isev. Accessed November 2026.

[3] National Center for Education Statistics. *Digest of Education Statistics*. Editions 1995–2025. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Education, Institute of Education Sciences. https://nces.ed.gov/programs/digest/. Accessed November 2026.

[4] National Center for Education Statistics. *Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS)*. Survey files, 1980–2025. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Education, Institute of Education Sciences. https://nces.ed.gov/ipeds/. Accessed November 2026.

[5] National Center for Education Statistics. *National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP)*. NAEP Data Service, 1990–2024. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Education, Institute of Education Sciences. https://www.nationsreportcard.gov/. Accessed November 2026.

[6] National Center for Science and Engineering Statistics. *Higher Education Research and Development Survey*. Data tables, FY2003–2024. Alexandria, VA: National Science Foundation. https://ncses.nsf.gov/surveys/higher-education-research-development. Accessed November 2026.

[7] National Center for Science and Engineering Statistics. *Survey of Earned Doctorates*. Data tables, 1994–2025. Alexandria, VA: National Science Foundation. https://ncses.nsf.gov/surveys/earned-doctorates. Accessed November 2026.

[8] National Center for Science and Engineering Statistics. *Survey of Federal Funds for Research and Development*. Data tables, FY1985–2024. Alexandria, VA: National Science Foundation. https://ncses.nsf.gov/surveys/federal-funds-research-development. Accessed November 2026.

[9] National Center for Science and Engineering Statistics. *Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates in Science and Engineering*. Data tables, 1994–2024. Alexandria, VA: National Science Foundation. https://ncses.nsf.gov/surveys/graduate-students-postdoctorates-s-e. Accessed November 2026.

[10] U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics. *Occupational Employment and Wage Statistics*. State estimates, 1999–2025. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Labor. https://www.bls.gov/oes/. Accessed November 2026.

[11] U.S. Census Bureau, Center for Economic Studies. *Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes (PSEO)*. Release R2025. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Commerce. https://lehd.ces.census.gov/data/pseo_experimental.html. Accessed November 2026.

[12] U.S. Census Bureau. *American Community Survey*. 1-year estimates and Public Use Microdata Sample, 2010–2025. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Commerce. https://data.census.gov/. Accessed November 2026.

[13] U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services. *H-1B Employer Data Hub*. Fiscal years 2009–2026. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Homeland Security. https://www.uscis.gov/tools/reports-and-studies/h-1b-employer-data-hub. Accessed November 2026.

[14] U.S. Department of Education, Office for Civil Rights. *Civil Rights Data Collection*. School years 1980–81 to 2023–24. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Education. https://civilrightsdata.ed.gov/. Accessed November 2026.

[15] U.S. Department of Education. *College Scorecard*. Institution and field-of-study data, 1996–2025. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Education. https://collegescorecard.ed.gov/data/. Accessed November 2026.

[16] U.S. Department of Homeland Security, Office of Homeland Security Statistics. *Yearbook of Immigration Statistics*. Fiscal years 1996–2024. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Homeland Security. https://ohss.dhs.gov/topics/immigration/yearbook. Accessed November 2026.

[17] U.S. Department of Labor, Employment and Training Administration, Office of Foreign Labor Certification. *LCA and PERM Disclosure Data*. Fiscal years 2008–2026. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Labor. https://www.dol.gov/agencies/eta/foreign-labor/performance. Accessed November 2026.

[18] U.S. Department of State, Bureau of Educational and Cultural Affairs. *BridgeUSA: Exchange Visitor Program Participants by State*. 2015–2025. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of State. https://j1visa.state.gov/. Accessed November 2026.

[19] U.S. Department of the Treasury, Bureau of the Fiscal Service. *USAspending.gov*. Award data, FY2008–2026. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of the Treasury. https://www.usaspending.gov/. Accessed November 2026.

[20] U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement, Student and Exchange Visitor Program. *SEVIS by the Numbers: Data Mapping Tool*. Monthly data, 2014–2026. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Homeland Security. https://studyinthestates.dhs.gov/sevis-data-mapping-tool. Accessed November 2026.

[21] U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement. *Student and Exchange Visitor Information System (SEVIS) Data*. Freedom of Information Act releases, 2008–2016. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Homeland Security. https://www.ice.gov/foia/library. Accessed November 2026.

[22] U.S. Patent and Trademark Office. *PatentsView*. Annualized patent data, grant years 1976–2025. Alexandria, VA: U.S. Patent and Trademark Office. https://patentsview.org/. Accessed November 2026.